TEXAS 4-H





CLOVER KIDS



TEXAS A&M AGRILIFE EXTENSION

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Welcome to Texas 4-H Clover Kids!

What is the Clover Kids Program?

Clover Kids is an exciting 4-H program for students in kindergarten through 2nd grade. Students participate in hands-on activities that are designed to be cooperative and fun!

What is the purpose of Clover Kids?

The purpose of the 4-H Clover Kids Program is to help youth learn social skills, reinforce school programs through informal noncompetitive experiential educational projects and activities, develop self-esteem, and build family strengths.

What is the goal of Clover Kids?

The primary goal is to promote the child's stages of development – intellectually, physically, socially, and emotionally. Clover Kids will have the chance to meet new friends, learn and practice social skills by working and playing in small groups, gain self-confidence, learn about themselves in a non-competitive learning environment, experience the joy and fun of learning, and master physical skills through hands-on or experiential learning (learning by doing).
Additionally, 4-H Clover Kids can learn and develop the following skills:

- Develop Self Esteem
- Decision Making Skills (making positive choices)
- Comprehension Skills (learning how to learn; positive attitudes toward learning)
- Mastering Physical Skills (enjoying constructive and creative play)
- Social-Interaction Skills (getting along with others)
- Diversity Skills (acceptance of others; exploring family and community relationships)

How do I sign up for Clover Kids and does it cost anything to join?

- There may not be a structured clover program in every county, so before you sign up, visit with you County Extension Agent and the staff at their office to learn about the opportunities available to you. You can find your local county Extension office at: http://counties.agrilife.org/.
- There is a $10 enrollment fee for Clover Kids to join 4-H. Enrollment sign-up is conducted through an online enrollment system and can be found at the following link: https://tx4h.tamu.edu/login.

Can parents, grandparents, guardians, and siblings be involved?

YES!! Everyone can be involved! Volunteers are the heart of the 4-H Clover Kids program! There is always something to volunteer for: either before, during, or after meetings. County Extension Agents are always looking for volunteers to help with a verity of county and district events.

All volunteers that work with our 4-H program must apply to become an active volunteer with the program. The application is through the same online enrollment system that is used for youth, 4-H Connect. It can be found at the following link: https://tx4h.tamu.edu/login. This application includes a background screening check, 4-H online training videos, any face-to-face trainings required by the county, and approval from the county Extension office. This ensures the safety of all youth involved and will help make all families feel at ease when their students are involved in 4-H Clover Kids activities.

What types of 4-H projects are available for Clover kids?

Emphasis is on providing project-related learning experiences and forms of recognition which are age appropriate and based on current youth development research. The individual project is the basis for a significant part of the education in 4-H. Projects and curricula approved by the Texas A&M AgriLife Extension Service for Clover Kids include:

Curricula:

- Hatching in the Classroom
- Yea 4-H!
- Junior Master Gardener

Projects:

- Rabbits
- Poultry
- Dog Care & Training
- Agronomy
- Consumer Education
- Fashion & Interior Design
- Food & Nutrition
- Health & Personal Safety
- Gardening & Horticulture
- Sportfishing
- Range Science
- Aquatic Science
- Entomology
- Forestry
- Wildlife & Fisheries
- STEM
- Photography
- Robotics
- Computer Science
- Public Speaking
- Theater & Performance Arts

A few additional notes about 4-H projects with Clover Kids:

- Clover Kids projects can't be entered in the traditional competitive events and activities reserved for 3rd through 12th graders.
- Instead, projects may be shown at an Extension-approved, non-competitive Clover Kids event.
- These exhibits and presentations earn participation awards only, recognizing kids for completing and sharing their work - not for judging or placing.

When and how to 4-H Clover Kids meet?

Clover Kids may meet as a part of a regular 4-H Club meeting with community clubs, project clubs, school clubs, afterschool clubs, military clubs or other special interest or enrichment curriculum groups. An adult volunteer coordinates the activity for each meeting. Check with your County Extension Agent to see what options are currently available or what would best fit your community if you were just getting started.

BIG 5 PROJECT AREAS

This guide is organized around the Big 5 project areas, the five main areas of focus that structure 4-H programming: Family & Community Health, Agriculture & Livestock, Natural Resources, Leadership/Citizenship/Entrepreneurship, and STEM/Photography/Performing Arts. Every activity in this guide falls under one of these five areas, helping Clover Kids build a foundation in each before they move into project-specific work in later grades.



Within each project area, you will find a table of contents listing the activities included, along with the materials, life skills, and step-by-step instructions needed to lead each one. Activities are grouped by project area so that volunteers and Extension staff can easily locate age-appropriate, hands-on lessons that reinforce the skills and knowledge tied to that area. As you plan Clover Kids meetings and events, use this structure to build a well-rounded experience that touches on all five areas throughout the year, giving students an early, engaging introduction to the full breadth of what 4-H has to offer.

BIG 5 PROJECT AREA: FAMILY & COMMUNITY HEALTH (FCH)

Fun with Foods.....7

Activity 1: Build a Better Plate.....7

Activity 2: Mystery Taste Test.....8

Activity 3: Where Does Breakfast Come From?.....8

Safety.....9

Activity 1: Safety at Home.....9

Activity 2: Bicycles and other Wheels.....10

Activity 3: This is an Emergency!.....**11**

Activity 4: Thumbs up! Thumbs down!.....**12**

Money Management.....13

Activity 1: Needs vs. Wants Sort.....13

Activity 2: Savings Jar Challenge.....13

Activity 3: Chore Store.....14

Physical Skills.....15

Activity 1: Mock Track Meet.....15

Activity 2: Coat Race.....15

Activity 3: Bicycle Skill Games.....16

Additional Activities (K-2).....17

Activity 1: Rainbow Plate Challenge.....17

Activity 2: Germ Busters.....17

Activity 3: Build-a-Feelings-Face.....17

Activity 4: My Helping Hands.....18

Fun with Foods

Activity 1: Build a Better Plate

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- a paper plate divided into five sections and labeled (fruits, vegetables, grains, protein, dairy)
- pictures of a wide variety of foods, cut apart
- glue

What to do:

1. Show the group the five food groups and give a couple of real examples of each (grains: bread, rice; protein: chicken, beans; dairy: milk, cheese).
2. Have each student sort their food pictures into the correct group before gluing anything down.
3. Once sorted, have students build a plate using at least one food from each group.
4. Ask each student to explain their plate: which food group has the most on it, and which could use more?
5. Talk as a group about why our bodies need foods from every group, not just one.

Suggestion: For a faster or repeatable version, laminate the plates and food pictures with a hook-and-loop dot on the back so students can rebuild a new plate each meeting.

Activity 2: Mystery Taste Test

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- 4-5 small food samples with different tastes and textures (examples: lemon slice, pretzel, apple, plain yogurt, pickle)
- small cups or napkins
- blindfolds or a request to close eyes

What to do:

1. Set out a small sample of each food in its own cup, out of sight of the group.
2. One at a time, have a student close their eyes and taste a small sample.
3. Ask them to describe it using taste and texture words (sweet, sour, salty, crunchy, chewy, smooth) before guessing what it is.
4. Reveal the food and talk about which tastes they noticed.
5. After everyone has had a turn, make a group chart sorting the foods into sweet, sour, salty, and other.

Suggestion: Check for food allergies ahead of time and offer a non-tasting role, such as chart-keeper, to any student who prefers not to taste.

Activity 3: Where Does Breakfast Come From?

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- pictures of common breakfast foods (bread, eggs, milk, orange juice, cereal)
- pictures of the source of each food (wheat field, chicken, dairy cow, orange tree, corn field)
- yarn or string to connect matches, or a simple worksheet

What to do:

1. Lay out the breakfast food pictures on one side and the source pictures on the other.
2. Ask students to match each breakfast food to where it came from before it reached the table.
3. Talk through each match: how did the food get from the farm to our kitchen?
4. Ask students to name what they ate for breakfast that morning and guess where it came from.
5. Discuss how farmers and ranchers play a role in getting food to our plates every day.

Suggestion: Tie this into the Agriculture & Livestock project area by inviting students to share if their own family raises any of these foods.

Section: Safety

Activity 1: Safety at Home

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

What to do:

1. Invite a resource person to talk about home safety. Ask parents to volunteer, especially if they work for any of the following:
    a. city or county health department
    b. fire department
    c. local insurance agency
    d. county nurse
    e. local chapter of the American Red Cross
2. Create some "hazards" around the center before students arrive and then conduct a group "hazard hunt." As you discover each hazard, discuss why it is a hazard and what should be done about it. Be sure to correct the hazard.

3. Examples of hazardous conditions:
    a. electrical and fire hazards
    b. cupboard doors open
    c. poisons
    d. electrical cord, appliances
    e. slippery rugs and floors
    f. ladders
    g. sharp tools
    h. proper labelling of containers
4. Draw floor plans of students' homes (younger students may need help) and map out an escape route from each room.
5. Practice fire drill procedures.
    a. close doors to hold back flames and smoke
    b. exiting out a low window

Activity 2: Bicycles and other Wheels

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- pen, paper, pencil, magic markers for individual lists
- markers, whiteboard for group list

What to do:

1. Make three columns on the blackboard. (If making individual lists, divide the paper into three columns.
2. In the first column list all the things you can think of that you ride in or play on that have wheels (car, bus, bike, skateboard).
3. Think of all the safety rules for each item on the list and record answers in the center column.

4. The third column is for individual or group response to the question: "Do I follow these safety rules?" Answer either by a show of hands from the entire group, or by a personal response in each child's notebook. Encourage group discussion.

Additional Activity: The following are some "Rules of the Road" for bicycles. Use these rules for discussion or find a resource person to go over these rules.

1. Yield the right-of-way to pedestrians when crossing a sidewalk and to cars when entering the street. Remember that many times they are not looking for you and may not see you.
2. Ride in single file when traffic conditions require and no more than two abreast at any time.
3. Signal your intentions to motorists, particularly at intersections.
4. Drive at a speed that is safe for the road. Remember that brakes will not work as well on loose gravel or wet pavement, where it is easier to skid out of control.
5. Keep both hands on the handlebars.
6. Use a carrier or basket for packages instead of trying to balance them on the bike itself.
7. Carry only one person per seat, so you can keep control.
8. Never, never "hitch on" to a moving vehicle. The driver can't see you and you could easily lose control.
9. Make sure you have reflectors. You may want to consider putting a bright-colored flag on the rear of your bike.
10. Wear bright, reflective clothing and use a headlight at night. The law requires a front white light and a red rear reflector which can be visible from 300 feet away.

Activity 3: This is an Emergency!

(role-play)
Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

What to do:
Pair up students for the following role plays:

1. The doorbell rings-there is a stranger at the door asking to use the phone.
2. You are home alone and the phone rings; someone wants to speak to your parent right away.
3. You lost your key to the house.
4. A stranger approaches you on the street.
5. A stranger tells you that your parents told them to pick you up.
6. Devise a secret code word to be used in this role-playing situation and encourage the students to go home and discuss with their parents an appropriate code word to be used by someone who picks them up in the place of their parents.

Activity 4: Thumbs up! Thumbs down!

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

What to do:
Choose someone to be "it." "It" will say, "I think it is safe to. . ." (one of the options listed below). If the group agrees that it is a safe thing to do, they will stick their thumbs up. If the group does not agree, they must point their thumbs down, indicating that this action is dangerous.

I think it is safe to:

- stand on this rocking chair.
- run up and down stairs.
- run around sharp corners in the house.
- look both ways before crossing the street.
- invite a stranger into the house if they ask to use the phone.
- spill a glass of water on the floor and leave it.
- leave these medicines on the table.
- go with a stranger if they say my parent sent them to pick me up.
- touch this radio with wet hands.
- wipe this spilled water up so I won't slip on it.
- stand on this stack of boxes to reach that high cabinet.
- try to light these matches by myself.
- walk downstairs with one hand holding the handrail.
- hide in my closet because I smell smoke.
- leave these toys in the middle of the floor.
- put all medicine away in a safe place.
- poke this screwdriver into this electrical outlet.
- call 911 from a safe place when my house is on fire.
- run back into my house to get my pet when my house is on fire.

Section: Money Management

Activity 1: Needs vs. Wants Sort

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- picture cards of items (food, water, a coat, a toy, candy, shoes, a video game)
- two labeled sorting areas: Needs and Wants

What to do:

1. Explain that a need is something we must have to stay safe and healthy, and a want is something nice to have but not required.
2. Show each picture card and ask the group to decide together: is this a need or a want?
3. Place each card in the correct area, talking through tricky ones together (like shoes: needed for feet, but do we need ten pairs?).
4. Ask each student to name one need and one want of their own.
5. Discuss why it's important to take care of needs before spending money on wants.

Suggestion: For an extra challenge, ask if any items could be both, and why (for example, a warm coat is a need, but a designer coat is more of a want).

Activity 2: Savings Jar Challenge

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- a clear jar or cup per student (or one shared class jar)
- play coins or real pennies/nickels/dimes for counting practice
- a picture of a simple savings goal (a book, a small toy, a treat)

What to do:

1. Show the group a savings goal and its cost in coins (keep it small, such as 25 cents).
2. Practice identifying and counting pennies, nickels, and dimes together.
3. Take turns adding coins to the jar and counting the new total out loud as a group.
4. Talk about how the jar fills up a little at a time, and that saving means waiting instead of

spending right away.
5. Once the jar reaches the goal amount, celebrate and talk about how it felt to wait and save.

Suggestion: If your group meets multiple times, keep a real jar going across meetings so students see saving happen over time, not just in one sitting.

Activity 3: Chore Store

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Responsibility/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- play money or paper "coupons"
- a simple list of classroom jobs (line leader, paper passer, clean-up helper)
- a few small prize items to set up as a pretend "store" (stickers, pencils, bookmarks)
- price tags for each prize (in play money amounts)

What to do:

1. Explain that people earn money by doing work and post the list of classroom jobs students can do to earn play money.
2. Let students take turns doing a job and earning their play money for it.
3. Set up the prize "store" with price tags on each item.
4. Let each student decide how to spend or save their earnings: buy a prize now or wait and save for a bigger one next time.
5. Discuss as a group: was it easy or hard to decide whether to spend or save? Why?

Suggestion: Run this over a few meetings so students can practice saving up for a bigger prize instead of always spending right away.

Section: Physical Skills

Activity 1: Mock Track Meet

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ physical skills
(The following inside games may be played on days when the weather will not allow students to play outside.)

Materials needed:

- string about 8 feet long with marshmallow strung on it
- paper plates
- butcher paper on wall
- crayons
- yardstick
- stool
- straws in a paper cover
- table
- feather
- ping pong ball
- penny
- blown up balloons (different colors)
- straws
- lifesavers

What to do:
Divide equally into teams. Each player will compete in only one event. The last event uses the whole team. Any number of points may be given to each event of the contest. Teams sit together, sending one player up to the front of the room to compete in each of the following events (team members may strategize to see who is the best team member for each event):

100 Yard Dash-A length of string is tied to the top of a chair. A marshmallow is strung on the string about 3 feet from the end. On the signal, each player chews up the string until he can get the marshmallow in his mouth. The first to reach the marshmallow wins.

Discus Throw-A paper plate is given each contestant, who tosses it as far as possible. Player cannot step over a given line. The farthest throw wins. Allow only 1 person to throw at a time.

High Jump-The difference is measured between how high a player can reach with one arm to mark on the butcher paper, and how high he can jump up, touching the wall, to make another mark. Each player makes a different colored mark on a sheet of butcher paper covering the wall. Each player gets two tries. A stool is needed to stand on for measuring. Contestants compete one at a time. The longest distance wins.

Javelin Throw: Each player is given a straw with its paper cover on. They tear off one end of the paper cover. On a signal, the player puts the straw in their mouth and blows off the cover while standing up to a line. The one traveling the farthest wins.

Broad Jump: Each player kneels or sits down with their mouth at table level. A feather (or ping pong ball) is placed on the edge, just in front of their mouth. On a signal, they get one blow to see how far they can send the feather. The one that travels farthest wins.

Two-Mile Race: Each player lies down flat on their back on the rug. A penny is placed on their nose. On a signal, each player tries to wiggle the penny off their nose. They may move their face in any way but may not move their head. The first one to get the penny off wins.

Shot Put: Each player stands up to a line and is given a large balloon. On a signal, they put a hand under or behind it and throw it as far as possible, without holding onto the tied end. The farthest throw wins.

Relay: The entire team lines up, one behind the other. Each player puts a straw in their mouth. The first player holds a ring-shaped candy on their straw. On a signal, they turn around and transfer it to the straw of the next person, passing it down the line. The last player runs to the front and transfers it back to the first player. First team to finish and crouch down wins. If it is dropped, the team must start that pass over.

Activity 2: Coat Race

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ physical skills
(This relay game will promote self-dressing skills among the younger age group, but it is fun for all ages to play.)

Materials needed for each team:

- coat with a zipper
- shirt with buttons
- a pair of shoes with tie shoelaces
- old socks
- gloves
- boots
- belts

What to do:

1. Divide players up into teams of four or five.
2. A coat is started at the front of each line. The first player puts it on, zips it completely, unzips it, and gives it to the second player. Each player follows the same procedure until one team is completely finished.

3. Continue this process with all dress items, adding as many different items as you wish, and repeating with items that prove to be difficult for students.

Activity 3: Bicycle Skill Games

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge/physical skills
Materials: Bicycles

What to do:

1. Figure 8 Test: Plan out a double line course shaped like an "8." Drive around it without touching the edges.
2. Rock Dodge: Lay out some sponges in a straight line, each about two yards apart. Ride up to the sponge, then turn your front wheel a little in one direction until you are past the object, then back while keeping a straight line. Keep going until you weave past all the "rocks."
3. Panic Stop: Set up a starting point for braking. Head toward it, then brake hard, shifting your weight to the rear of the bike. Mark with chalk the point where the bicycle stopped. You should be able to stop at the shortest distance possible with out skidding your tires. If you skid, release the front brake a little.
4. Obstacle Course: Place eight cans each eight feet apart, forming a line. After the last can, mark off 16 feet and place a five-foot chute, 12 inches wide. Begin on each side of the first can, and drive at a steady speed through the course weaving inside and out around the cans while keeping your body straight on the bike. Without touching the cans or the sides of the chute, you must wind up in the chute within 12 inches of the stop line. (Younger students who do not ride bikes may be "official helpers" and can watch for an infringement of rules (i.e. knocking over cans, etc.).

- Contact your local police or sheriff's department to see if they have a program similar to this one. Perhaps they will volunteer to do this program for you.

Additional Activities (K-2)

Activity 1: Rainbow Plate Challenge

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Healthy Lifestyle Choices/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- pictures of fruits and vegetables cut from magazines or printed
- one paper plate per child
- glue
- crayons or markers

What to do:

1. Give each child a paper plate.
2. Look through the fruit and vegetable pictures together and talk about their colors.
3. Have each child glue at least one fruit or vegetable of every color of the rainbow onto their plate.
4. When plates are full, let students share which colorful food is their favorite.
5. Discuss why eating many colors of food helps our bodies stay healthy.

Suggestion: Real fruit slices can be used instead of pictures for a tasting version of this activity.

Activity 2: Germ Busters

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Health & Personal Safety

Materials needed:

- fine glitter (or lotion mixed with glitter)
- sink or water basin
- soap
- paper towels

What to do:

1. Put a small dab of lotion on each child's hands and sprinkle with glitter, explaining that the glitter represents germs.
2. Have students look at how the "germs" cover their hands and spread to things they touch.
3. Ask students to wash their hands with soap for 20 seconds.
4. Check hands after washing to see how much glitter is gone.
5. Discuss when we should wash our hands (before eating, after the bathroom, after playing outside, etc.).

Suggestion: Sing the ABC song once or "Happy Birthday" twice while washing to help students time 20 seconds.

Activity 3: Build-a-Feelings-Face

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Emotional Awareness

Materials needed:

- paper plates
- construction paper scraps
- glue
- crayons
- yarn

What to do:

1. Talk with students about different feelings: happy, sad, angry, surprised, scared.
2. Give each child a paper plate and have them choose a feeling to create.
3. Use construction paper, yarn, and crayons to build a face showing that feeling.
4. Have each child hold up their plate and share a time they felt that way.
5. Discuss healthy ways to handle big feelings.

Suggestion: Make a full set of feelings faces as a group so students can point to how they feel at future meetings.

Activity 4: My Helping Hands

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social Interaction/Responsibility

Materials needed:

- construction paper
- scissors (or pre-cut hand shapes)
- markers
- glue

What to do:

1. Trace or cut out a paper hand shape for each child.
2. Talk about ways students can help at home and in their community (setting the table, feeding a pet, picking up toys, helping a neighbor).
3. Have each child draw or write one way they help on their paper hand.
4. Glue all the hands together in a circle or chain to display as a group "Helping Hands" wreath.
5. Discuss how our community is stronger when everyone helps.

Suggestion: Add a new hand each meeting to grow the display throughout the year.

BIG 5 PROJECT AREA: AGRICULTURE & LIVESTOCK

Exploring Plants.....20
Activity 1: How Seeds Germinate and Grow.....20
Activity 2: Potting a plant.....20
Activity 3: Field Trips.....21
Activity 4: Rooting Plant Cuttings.....21
Activity 5: An Experiment with Light.....21
Activity 6: Planting a Terrarium.....22
Pets.....23
Activity 1: Landlubber Aquarium.....23
Activity 2: Pet Scene.....23
Activity 3: Pet Mobile.....24
Activity 4: Pet Display.....24
Additional Activities (K-2).....25
Activity 1: Guess the Baby Animal.....25
Activity 2: What Do Farm Animals Eat?.....25
Activity 3: From Cotton Field to T-Shirt.....26
Activity 4: Barnyard Bingo.....26
Activity 5: Paper Plate Farm Animal Craft.....27

Exploring Plants

Activity 1: How Seeds Germinate and Grow

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- glass jars
- paper towels
- bean and corn seeds
- flowerpots
- soil

What to do:

1. Line the sides and bottom of a glass or jar with a paper towel.
2. Add water to the wet towel and leave extra water on the bottom. Keep water in bottom at all times.
3. Stuff the center with more wet towels to keep the first towel firmly against the sides of the glass.
4. Slip two beans and two corn seeds between the glass and the first towel.
5. Look at the glass each day. Observe the seed coat coming off, the corn and beans emerging, and the development of roots.

Results: After several days, the shoots or stems will be growing upward, and the roots will be growing downward. Invert the glass. After several more days the stems and roots will turn so that again the stems grow up and the roots grow down. As the seeds continue to grow, they appear to be drying. The plants seem to be getting everything they need from photosynthesis, carbon dioxide, water and sunlight. They are missing some minerals that are found in soil, however. Explain that up to this point each plant was living off itself. It was nourished from the food stored in the seed. The seeds can be revived by going one step further and planting them in soil.

Activity 2: Potting a plant

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- clay or plastic pots with drainage holes
- potting soil
- water

What to do:

1. Place 1/2 to 1 inch of gravel in the bottom of the container.
2. Add a little soil and set the plant in the pot
3. Slowly add more soil and pack gently around the roots. Repeat until soil is 1/2 inch from top.
4. Water plant thoroughly, but only often enough to prevent wilting.

Activity 3: Field Trips

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/subject matter knowledge

- visit a plant and shrub nursery
- visit the local flower shop
- hike through a park naming as many plants as you can
- ask a flower shop owner to demonstrate flower arranging, etc.

Activity 4: Rooting Plant Cuttings

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- flowerpot
- a gallon-size milk carton (cut the top off, leaving the bottom 4 inches)
- sharp nail for making holes in the bottom of the milk carton
- fine gravel
- rooting mixture of ½ sand and ½ peat moss
- coleus, sultana, ivy, geranium or other easily rooting plant
- scissors
- small plastic bags

What to do:

1. Make holes in the bottom of the gallon milk carton, ¼ to ½ inch across.
2. Place 1 inch of gravel in the bottom of the container.
3. Fill the container within ½ inch of the top with the rooting mixture.
4. Make a cutting about 6 inches long from the coleus, sultana, ivy, geranium, etc.
5. Strip off the leaves from the bottom 3 to 4 inches.
6. Plant the cutting in the rooting box with 3 inches (about 1/3 its height) above the surface of the soil.
7. Place your rooting box in a warm area where there is indirect sunlight during a large part of the day.
8. Attach a plastic bag over the plants and box. Fasten with a rubber band.
9. Water as needed to keep the soil moist to the touch.
10. Move the plants to pots when they develop roots about 3 inches long. This will take 3 to 6 weeks.

SEE ADDITIONAL ACTIVITY - POTTING A PLANT

Activity 5: An Experiment with Light

(its effect on plant growth)
Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- water tray
- 3 quart-size milk cartons per child
- nail to punch holes in the bottom of carton

- tomato seeds
- loose pulverized soil

What to do:

1. Cut off the bottom 3 inches of the quart-size milk cartons.
2. Number them 1, 2, and 3.
3. Punch holes in the bottom with a large nail.
4. Fill the cartons with loose pulverized soil.
5. Plant 4 tomato seeds in each carton ¼ to ½ inch deep. Place cartons in water trays.
6. Keep soil moist; add water until the water just runs out of the holes you punched.
7. Place box number 1 in a sunny room; box number 2 in a room without direct sunlight; box number 3 under a cardboard box to keep out all light.
8. Thin to one strong plant when plants are 2 to 3 inches high.
   Results: Discuss with group the following information: The plants that have the darkest green color (an indication of the presence of chlorophyll) have successfully used the energy of the sun to manufacture sugar. This sugar is used by the plants for food to help them grow. The plants growing in the dark have turned white, losing their chlorophyll. The plants which are a lighter green are not getting enough direct sunlight. Without sunlight and chlorophyll, the plant cannot make food and grow.

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITY: Place a sweet potato in a glass of water. The sweet potato will sprout, and the vine will grow 10 to 20 feet long. Vary the moisture and light to see the effect on the plant.

Activity 6: Planting a Terrarium

(Students can each build a small individual terrarium or work together on one shared class terrarium.)
Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- clean, interesting-looking containers
- soil
- fertilizer
- drainage material (small rocks or coarse gravel)
- small plants

What to do:

1. Place the gravel or small rocks in the bottom of the containers.
2. Mix a teaspoonful of fertilizer with the soil. Use less fertilizer for a small terrarium.
3. Place the soil on top of the gravel or rocks.
4. Place your moss and plant your plants in an interesting arrangement, working together to decide on a layout.
5. Cover open vessels loosely to decrease loss of moisture.
6. Water as needed.

The Missouri 4-H staff expresses appreciation to the following Cooperative Extension Services for use of 4-H project material on plant exploration: Iowa State University, University of California, South Dakota State University, University of Wisconsin.

Section: Pets

Activity 1: Landlubber Aquarium

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills

Materials needed:

- an old aquarium or cardboard box
- playdough
- macaroni
- blue construction paper
- sand
- rocks
- plastic flowers

What to do:

6. Fashion frogs, fish, lily pads, tadpoles, butterflies, snails, etc., out of playdough.
7. Arrange sand inside the aquarium to form land. Use blue construction paper for water. Arrange plastic flowers and animals as desired.

Suggestion: If many students are involved, divide students into groups of 6 or 7 and decorate one box per group.

Activity 2: Pet Scene

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills

Materials needed:

- old magazines and catalogs
- cardboard to be used for backing
- magic markers, crayons
- scissors
- glue

What to do:

1. Draw or cut out a picture of a favorite pet or animal from a magazine or coloring book.
2. Glue picture to cardboard backing and cut out.
3. Glue a 1-inch piece of cardboard to the bottom of the figure so it can stand.
4. Lay a long segment of butcher paper across 2 or 3 tables.
5. Draw a long winding yellow brick (or red brick, or dirt) road on the length of paper.
6. Divide length into 2-foot sections and allow each child to draw in appropriate background (trees, flowers, ponds, mountains, barns, etc.) on his/her section.
7. Arrange animals on finished background and display.

Suggestions:

1. Add cut-out figures of people to display.
2. Instead of drawing animal figures, allow students to fashion animals out of clay or playdough

Activity 3: Pet Mobile

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills

Materials needed:

- metal key ring
- thin wire or string
- several short wooden dowels
- 1 long wooden dowel

What to do:

1. Cut a length of string or wire 2 1/2 times as long as the long wooden dowel.
2. Thread the string or wire through the key ring and attach both ends of string to corresponding ends of dowel so dowel will be level when suspended from ceiling by ring.
3. Attach short dowels to long dowel by string or wire to form a mobile.
4. Attach colored drawings or papier mache animals to short dowels with wire or string.
5. Display.

Activity 4: Pet Display

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction

Materials needed:

- pictures of students and their pets
- colored construction paper
- glue
- magic markers

What to do:

1. Mount pictures of students and their pets on pieces of construction paper.
2. Below each picture put the following information:
    a. Name of pet
    b. Identifying marks or characteristics
    c. Size/Weight
    d. Food
    e. Habits and Tricks
3. Three hole-punch all pages and put into a scrap book for display.

Suggestions for additional activities:

1. Make copies of all the pictures so that each child can have their own scrapbook. (This could also be used as a PR tool for recruitment purposes.)
2. Students can write their own favorite story about their pet and put into the scrapbook.

Additional Activities (K-2)

Activity 1: Guess the Baby Animal

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- picture cards of baby farm animals and their parents (calf/cow, foal/horse, kid/goat, lamb/sheep, piglet/pig, chick/hen)

What to do:

1. Lay out the parent animal cards where students can see them.
2. Show students one baby animal card at a time and ask them to guess which parent it belongs to.
3. Once guessed, place the baby card next to its parent card.
4. Talk about the special name for each baby animal.
5. Play again, mixing up the cards, until everyone has had a turn to match.

Suggestion: Make it a movement game by taping parent cards around the room and having students carry their baby card to the matching parent.

Activity 2: What Do Farm Animals Eat?

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- pictures of farm animals (cow, chicken, horse, pig, sheep)
- pictures of feed (hay, grain, corn, kitchen scraps) or actual feedstuffs
- paper plates or hula hoops

What to do:

1. Place an animal picture on or near each paper plate or hoop around the room.
2. Give students the feed pictures and let them decide which animal eats which food.
3. Have students place each feed picture with the correct animal.
4. Discuss as a group why farmers need to feed animals the right food to keep them healthy.
5. Talk about how farmers care for animals every day, even on holidays and weekends.

Suggestion: Include a "trick" food like pizza to spark discussion about foods animals should NOT eat.

Activity 3: From Cotton Field to T-Shirt

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Social Interaction

Materials needed:

- a small amount of raw cotton (available at craft stores)
- cotton balls
- a cotton t-shirt or fabric swatch
- pictures of a Texas cotton field
- glue
- paper

What to do:

1. Show students a picture of a Texas cotton field and explain that cotton is one of the biggest crops grown in our state.
2. Pass around raw cotton and cotton balls for students to feel and compare.
3. Show the cotton t-shirt or fabric and explain that fibers from the cotton plant are spun into thread and woven into cloth.
4. Let students glue a few cotton balls onto paper to create a cotton plant craft.
5. Talk about other things made from cotton (shirts, towels, blue jeans, and more).

Suggestion: Invite a local cotton farmer or Extension agent to share more about how cotton is grown and harvested in your county.

Activity 4: Barnyard Bingo

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social Interaction/Mastering Physical Skills

Materials needed:

- none required (optional: pictures of farm animals)

What to do:

1. Seat or stand students in a circle.
2. Call out a farm animal name (cow, pig, horse, duck, sheep, rooster).
3. Have all the students make that animal's sound and movement together.
4. Continue with new animals, picking up the pace as students get comfortable.
5. Let a child take a turn calling out the next animal.

Suggestion: End with "Farmer Says," where students must freeze when the farmer calls "quiet on the farm!"

Activity 5: Paper Plate Farm Animal Craft

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Mastering Physical Skills/Self-concept

Materials needed:

- paper plates
- construction paper
- glue
- crayons or markers
- cotton balls (optional, for sheep)

What to do:

1. Let each child choose a favorite farm animal to make (cow, pig, chicken, sheep, horse).
2. Use construction paper scraps to add ears, snouts, feathers, or wool to the paper plate.
3. Draw on eyes, a nose, and other details with crayons or markers.
4. Once finished, have students introduce their animal and share one fun fact about it.
5. Display the finished animals together to make a classroom "farm."

Suggestion: Pair this with Barnyard Bingo for a full farm-themed meeting.

BIG 5 PROJECT AREA: NATURAL RESOURCES

Activity 1: Bird Feeders.....28
Additional Activities (K-2).....29
Activity 1: Water Cycle in a Bag.....29
Activity 2: Sort It Out! Recycle, Reuse, Trash.....29
Activity 3: Leaf & Bark Rubbing Hunt.....29
Activity 4: Whose Habitat Is It?.....30
Activity 5: Litter Bug Clean-Up Relay.....30

Activity 1: Bird Feeders

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction

Simple bird feeder:

- Attach a simple wooden platform near a window or wire to a tree where students can watch birds feeding.

Suet feeder:

- Mount large pine cones on individual wooden platforms (1 per child).
- Melt beef suet (obtained from a butcher) and pour over each pine cone.
- Add dabs of peanut butter and cereal.
- Attach to a tree or near a window so students can watch birds feeding.

Additional Activities (K-2)

Activity 1: Water Cycle in a Bag

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- quart-size resealable plastic bags
- blue food coloring
- water
- permanent marker
- tape
- sunny window

What to do:

1. Draw a sun, cloud, and arrows on the outside of a plastic bag to show the water cycle.
2. Fill the bag about 1/3 full with water and add a drop of blue food coloring.
3. Seal the bag tightly and tape it to a sunny window.
4. Check the bag each day for several days and watch water droplets form and "rain" down the inside of the bag.
5. Talk about how the sun heats water, it evaporates, forms clouds, and falls back down as rain.

Suggestion: Make one bag per child so they can each observe and track their own water cycle at home.

Activity 2: Sort It Out! Recycle, Reuse, Trash

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- three labeled bins or boxes (Recycle, Reuse, Trash)
- clean sample items (paper, plastic bottle, picture of a banana peel, cardboard box, old t-shirt)

What to do:

1. Set out the three labeled bins where students can see them.
2. Show students each sample item one at a time and talk about what it is.
3. Ask the group to decide together which bin the item belongs in and why.
4. Place the item in the chosen bin.
5. After sorting everything, talk about why taking care of our resources matters.

Suggestion: Take a short walk outside afterward to look for real examples of things that could be recycled or reused.

Activity 3: Leaf & Bark Rubbing Hunt

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Mastering Physical Skills

Materials needed:

- plain paper
- crayons with wrapper removed
- clipboard (optional)
- outdoor space with trees

What to do:

1. Give each child paper and a crayon.
2. Take students outside to find different leaves and tree trunks.
3. Show students how to place paper over a leaf or against bark and rub the crayon sideways to reveal the texture.
4. Collect several different rubbings and compare how they look different.
5. Talk about how trees are a natural resource that give us shade, clean air, wood, and homes for animals.

Suggestion: Label each rubbing with the tree it came from, if known, and start a nature journal.

Activity 4: Whose Habitat Is It?

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- pictures of habitats (pond, forest, prairie, desert)
- pictures of animals that live in each (fish, duck, deer, owl, prairie dog, bison, roadrunner)

What to do:

1. Place the four habitat pictures around the room.
2. Give students animal pictures and ask them to decide where each animal lives.
3. Have students carry or place their animal picture next to the matching habitat.
4. Talk about why each animal is suited to that habitat (fur, feathers, ability to swim, etc.).
5. Discuss the different habitats found across Texas.

Suggestion: Add a Texas map and mark where each habitat type can be found in our state.

Activity 5: Litter Bug Clean-Up Relay

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social Interaction/Responsibility

Materials needed:

- clean, safe pretend litter (crumpled paper, plastic bottle caps, foam pieces)
- two buckets
- gloves (optional)

What to do:

1. Scatter the pretend litter across a safe indoor or outdoor space.
2. Divide students into small groups and give each group a bucket.
3. On "go," have students pick up as much pretend litter as they can and place it in their bucket.
4. Gather back together and count how much litter was collected as a whole group.
5. Talk about how picking up litter helps protect animals, water, and land.

Suggestion: Keep this non-competitive by celebrating the group's total instead of which team "won."

BIG 5 PROJECT AREA: LEADERSHIP, CITIZENSHIP, & PERFORMING ARTS

Meet Me.....34
Activity 1: Autobiography.....34
Activity 2: Getting Acquainted.....36
Activity 3: Human Bingo.....36
Activity 4: All About Me Poster.....36
Activity 5: What Matters to Me.....37
Activity 6: Observation.....37
Activity 7: Earthquake!.....42
Activity 8: Scavenger Hunt.....38
Activity 9: Shadow Art.....38
Manners.....40
Activity 1: Good Manners Puppet Show.....40
Activity 2: Manners Match-Up.....40
Activity 3: Kindness Bingo.....40
Activity 4: Roleplaying: Conflict/ Resolution.....57

Citizenship.....48
Activity 1: Rule Detectives.....48
Activity 2: Our Class Votes!.....48
Activity 3: Building our Community.....48
Activity 3: Our Class Votes!.....48
Activity 4: Helping My Community Collage.....49
Activity 5: Texas & American Flag Craft.....49
Geography.....40
Activity 1: Make a Puzzle.....41
Activity 2: I'm Going to Take a Trip.....41
Activity 3: What Am I?.....42
Activity 4: Around the World Day.....44
Activity 5: Bake a State.....43
Activity 6: Lewis and Clark Expeditions.....44
Activity 7: Friendship Stick.....50
Careers/Occupations.....46
Activity 1: What's Your Trade?.....46
Activity 2: Spinning Yarns.....46

Activity 3: Dress for a Career.....47

Performance Arts: Drama/Writing/Storytelling.....53
Activity 1: Name the Animal.....53
Activity 2: Dress for Your Mood.....53
Activity 3: Pantomimes 54
Activity 4: The Lost Story.....55
Activity 5: Playacting.....55
Activity 6: String-a-Ring-Tell-a-Story Game.....57
Activity 7: Mother Goose Charades.....57
Activity 8: Unravel the Story.....58
Performance Arts: Puppets and Paper.....59
Activity 1: Create a Seasonal Bulletin Board or Wall Mural.....59
Activity 2: Making Puppets.....59
Activity 3: Stage Projects.....59
Activity 4: Happy Sad Faces.....62
Activity 5: Quick Draw.....63Activity 5: Quick Draw.....63
Activity 6: Puppet Promotional.....63Activity 6: Puppet Promotional.....63
Activity 7: Paper Collage.....64Activity 7: Paper Collage.....64
Activity 8: Paper Mache.....64Activity 8: Paper Mache.....64
Performance Arts: Music.....81
Activity 1: Let's Make Music-Constructing Musical Instruments.....81
Activity 2: Music Concert.....82
Activity 3: Freeze Dance Rhythm Game.....85

Section: Meet Me

Activity 1: Autobiography

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction

Materials needed:

- (SUGGESTION: Have students make their own scrapbook pages.)
- Activity 1 Handout: Autobiography
- Scrapbook Paper and/or scrapbook supplies (stickers, tape, glue)
- Large scrapbook to combine pages

What to do:

1. Send notes home to parents of 4-H members explaining the goals of this activity and requesting their help and cooperation.
2. Send home the attached handout with suggested questions for the members to answer with the help of parents.
3. Ask members to bring their completed handout along with a picture of themselves as a baby to create an “Autobiography” scrapbook page.
4. Compile pages into a large group scrapbook and share results with group as time allows.

Activity 1 Handout: Autobiography

My Name is: _____

Who chose my name? _____

The day I was born was: _____

How big I was: (length & weight) _____

Where I was born? (Hospital) _____

Where I was born? (City) _____

Where I was born? (State) _____

My favorite foods: _____

My favorite toys: _____

My favorite color: _____

My first words were: _____

When I took my first steps: _____

My first book was: _____

Activity 2: Getting Acquainted

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- A simple list of (5-10) interview questions (favorite color, favorite animal, favorite thing to do outside, something that makes them laugh)

What to do:

1. Put students into pairs.
2. Give each pair a few minutes to interview each other using the question list, with an adult helping any student who needs it.
3. Bring the group back together and have each student introduce their partner, sharing one or two things they learned.
4. Ask the group: what was one thing you had in common with your partner, and one thing that was different?

Suggestion: Rotate partners and repeat the activity at a later meeting so students get to know more of the group over time.

Activity 3: Human Bingo

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- One Human Bingo card per student (see attached grid)
- Fill in a description in each space for the student to find (Ex: Someone who likes to read books, someone who is wearing eyeglasses, someone who owns a pet)
- Pencils or crayons

What to do:

1. Give each student a Human Bingo card.
2. Have students mingle and ask each other questions to find someone who matches each square.
3. When a match is found, that person signs or marks the square (a person may only be used once per card).
4. Play until several students fill a row, or set a time limit and see how many squares the group fills together.
5. Gather as a group and share a few of the more interesting things students learned about each other.

Suggestion: Keep this activity non-competitive: the goal is mingling and getting acquainted, not finishing first.

Activity 3 Handout: Bingo Card (Blank)

My Name is: _____

Activity 4: All About Me Poster

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- One sheet of paper or poster board per student
- Crayons or markers
- Magazine pictures or stickers (optional)

What to do:

1. Give each student a sheet of paper divided into four boxes: My Favorites, My Family, Things I'm Good At, and Things I Want to Try.
2. Let students draw or glue pictures in each box (writing a word or two is great, but drawing is just as good).
3. Give students time to fill in all four boxes.
4. Let each student share their poster with the group, one box at a time.
5. Talk as a group about how everyone's poster looks different, and that's what makes each person unique.

Suggestion: Display the finished posters together on a wall so the group can see everyone's at a glance.

Activity 5: What Matters to Me

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- Picture cards showing different values (sharing, honesty, hard work, kindness, helping others, trying your best)

What to do:

1. Lay out the value picture cards where everyone can see them.
2. Talk through each card together and make sure everyone understands what it means.
3. Ask each student to pick the one or two cards that matter most to them.
4. Give each student a turn to share their pick and explain why in a sentence or two.
5. Discuss as a group: can you think of a time you showed one of these values?

Suggestion: Keep a running list of the values the group picks most often and revisit it later in the year.

Activity 6: Observation

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making skills
Materials needed:

- Players seated in a circle
- A tray with 5 to 6 items on it

What to do:

1. One child is chosen to be "it." He/She walks around the circle letting the others look at the tray for about 15 seconds.
2. Tell students to watch closely and try to remember everything they see.
3. Set the tray down and ask the child who carried the tray to sit behind a screen (or somewhere else where he/she cannot be seen by the other students).
4. Ask the group questions about the child who carried the tray rather than the objects on the tray.

Sample questions:

- Who carried the tray?
- What color was their hair?
- What color were their eyes?
- What color shirt, pants, dress, socks, shoes, hair ribbon, etc. did they have on?
- Were they wearing glasses?
- Did they smile, talk, etc.? If they talked, what did they say?

Talk about how many details the group remembered together and give everyone a turn to be "it." (Depending on the number of questions asked, this game may last only a short while or several minutes. Follow up with a discussion on what we notice about others (their attitude, if they smile or talk, etc.), and why we notice these things.

Activity 7: Earthquake!

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- chairs
- name tags with the names of the players printed on them
- scotch tape

What to do:

1. Tape or stick a name tag to the shirt of each player.
2. Seat players in a circle with "it" in the middle. The adult leader should be "it" the first time around.
3. There should be just enough chairs for all players except for the person who is “it."
4. The person who is "It" approaches one of the players and asks, "Who are your neighbors?" The player being questioned must name them correctly. Then "it" asks, "Are you planning to move north or south?" If the player answers "north," everyone in the circle must move to their right one chair. If the player answers "south," everyone must move to the left one chair. If the player answers "earthquake," everyone shifts any where they please. During the shifting, "it" at tempts to get a seat, and the person without a seat becomes "it."
   Suggestions: This game may also be played as a get-acquainted activity by using the players’ real names instead of state names.

Activity 8: Scavenger Hunt

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/teamwork/communication

Materials needed:

- a list of articles that could be found either on the students themselves or somewhere in the room (sample list might include the following items: a white shoelace, a blue tennis shoe, a boot, a hair ribbon, a sweater, a pencil, a white piece of paper, red colored item, etc.).
- a medium-sized cardboard box for each team

What to do:

1. Divide the students into teams of four to six (you can do more for larger groups).
2. Space all the teams out an equal distance from one central base, such as a chair in the middle of the room.
3. Place someone in the chair to be the judge. Each team should place their box at the judge's feet.
4. Each team should select one person to be the runner. When an item is called for from the list, each team must find the item and then each runner must bring that item to the judge.
5. If the judge accepts the item, the runner places it in the team's box before returning for the next item.
6. Give teams 45 seconds to 1 minute to find each item before time is called, and celebrate every team for what they found rather than keeping score.

This game may be played several times using different lists, or by substituting colors in place of specified items. Teams may also be re-chosen with more or fewer members, all boys or all girls, etc.

Activity 9: Shadow Art

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept

Materials needed:

- a large light-colored piece of paper
- black construction paper
- white construction paper
- pencil
- flashlight or lamp
- glue
- scissors
- a somewhat darkened room

What to do:

1. Explain to the students that you are going to make pictures of their shadows. One at a time, ask each child to sit sideways near a bare wall.
2. Place a large piece of paper on the wall so it is level with the child's head.
3. Slightly darken the room and shine the lamp or flashlight to project the child's shadow profile on the paper.
4. Trace the shadow on paper. Help the child cut out their shadow profile.
5. The outline can then be traced onto black construction paper.
6. Cut the outline out again and mount the black shadow figure on a larger piece of white construction paper.
7. Glue paper hangers to the back so the child can hang it in their room.

Additional activities:

- Variation 1: Place the students' names in a box. Each day of the week have a drawing of names from the box (divide the number of days it will take to complete the unit into the number of total students to arrive at the number of students who should be selected each day). The names chosen are the "Meet Me Specials" of the day where students can share about themselves (See Meet Me: Activity 1 - Autobiography or Meet Me: Activity 4 – All About Me Poster for ideas).
- Variation 2: Place the students' names in a box. Each day of the week have a drawing of names from the box (divide the number of days it will take to complete the unit into the number of total students to arrive at the number of students who should be selected each day). Ask the rest of the students to state the good things they like about the person chosen. Be prepared to start the students off. Make sure they understand only positive comments can be made. Set a limit of 5 to 10 comments for each child, so the lists will be equal.

Section: Manners

Activity 1: Good Manners Puppet Show

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- Two puppets (List of activities to make puppets is located on Pg. XX – Section: Creativity with Puppets & Paper

What to do:

1. Introduce the two puppets: one who forgets their manners, and one who gently reminds them.
2. Act out a short scene: the forgetful puppet grabs a toy without asking, interrupts, or forgets to say please.
3. Have the second puppet notice and ask the group: "What should they have said or done instead?"
4. Let students call out the polite words or actions, then have the puppets try again the right way.
5. Repeat with two or three more everyday scenes: sneezing without covering your nose & mouth, not saying thank you for a gift, or interrupting someone who is talking.

Suggestion: Let student volunteers take turns being the puppeteers once they get the hang of it.

Activity 2: Manners Match-Up

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Social Interaction

Materials needed:

- picture or word cards showing everyday situations (someone sneezes, someone gives you a gift, you want a turn on the swing, you bump into someone)
- picture or word cards showing polite responses (cover your mouth, say thank you, ask nicely and wait your turn, say excuse me)

What to do:

1. Lay out the situation cards on one side and the polite response cards on the other.
2. Take turns matching each situation to the polite response that fits.
3. Talk through each match: why is that the polite thing to do?
4. Ask for a volunteer to act out one matched pair for the group.
5. Discuss as a group: which of these do you already do? Which one could you practice more?

Suggestion: Send a copy of the situation cards home so families can keep practicing together.

Activity 3: Kindness Bingo

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social Interaction/Self-concept

Materials needed:

- Bingo cards (See template on page ##) with pictures or simple words of kind acts (smiled at a friend, said please and thank you, helped clean up, shared a toy, gave a compliment)
- Bingo markers or crayons

What to do:

1. Give each child a Kindness Bingo card.
2. Encourage students to complete kind acts during the meeting or throughout the week and mark the matching square.
3. When a child gets three in a row, celebrate with a group cheer.
4. Gather as a group to talk about how it felt to be kind and to be shown kindness.

Suggestion: Send the bingo card home so families can help track acts of kindness throughout the week.

Activity 4: Roleplaying: Conflict/ Resolution

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept /Social Interaction/ Decision Making Skills

Start a group discussion by explaining that everyone has their own "pet peeves" or situations when they find that the things others do and say bother them. The adult leading the discussion should volunteer one of his/her pet peeves and allow students to volunteer theirs. Discuss appropriate ways of handling these situations. The following guidelines are helpful in discussing ways to handle conflict resolution situations:

- Each one is entitled to tell their side of the story.
- Neither party will accuse the other party.
- Is there a compromise which will satisfy both parties?

List students' suggestions on the whiteboard or a large sheet of paper. For the last five to ten minutes, have students act out ways to solve conflicts using ideas from the discussion.

Section: Geography

Section: Citizenship

Activity 1: Rule Detectives

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Citizenship/Decision Making Skills/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- magnifying glasses (real or paper craft)
- pictures showing rules being followed (crossing at a crosswalk, raising a hand, wearing a seatbelt)

What to do:

1. Give each child a magnifying glass (or paper cutout of one).
2. Show pictures of students following different rules and ask the group to "detect" what rule is being followed.
3. Talk about why that rule keeps people safe or helps things run smoothly.
4. Ask students to think of a rule at home, school, or 4-H and share it with the group.
5. Discuss how rules help everyone get along and stay safe.
6. Suggestion: Make a group "Rules We Follow" poster to display at meetings.

Activity 2: Our Class Votes!

Life Skills: Citizenship/Decision Making Skills/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- two or three simple choices (two book covers, two snack options, two songs)
- a decorated ballot box (shoebox)
- paper slips

What to do:

1. Show students two or three choices for something the group will do together.
2. Explain that voting means everyone gets to have a say, and the choice with the most votes wins.
3. Give each child a paper slip to mark or draw their choice and place it in the ballot box.
4. Count the votes together as a group.
5. Talk about how voting is one way people help make decisions in our community and country.

Suggestion: Let a different child "count the votes" out loud each time you play to build confidence with numbers.

Activity 3: Building Our Community

Audience: K–2
Life Skills: Citizenship/Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- Plastic cups or building blocks
- A flat surface

What to do:

1. Divide students into small groups of 3–4.
2. Give each group an equal set of cups or blocks.
3. Explain that their challenge is to **build the tallest tower they can** & work**while working together as a team**.
4. Before beginning, have each group decide how they will:
    a. Share the materials
    b. Take turns
    c. Listen to everyone's ideas
    d. Help one another
5. Build for a set amount of time. Encourage students to make sure **everyone has a job and a chance to participate**.
6. Try a second round. This time, allow students to talk and make a plan before they begin.
7. After the activity, discuss:
    a. How did you decide what to build?
    b. Did everyone get a chance to share an idea?
    c. What happened when someone disagreed?
    d. How did you help your teammates?
    e. Why is it important to listen to others?
    f. How is working on a team like being part of a community?
8. **Citizenship Connection:** Explain that good citizens work together to make their school, club, neighborhood, and community better. They **share, cooperate, listen, take turns, follow rules, respect others, and help when someone needs it.**

Another Variation: You could add **"Community Challenge Cards."** After the first round, give each team a simple situation:

- **Everyone gets a turn:** Make sure every team member gets to add at least one block.
- **Share the resources:** Your team has fewer blocks than you expected. Decide how to use them fairly.
- **Listen to every voice:** Each person must share one idea before the team starts.
- **Help a neighbor:** Another team needs one block. Decide how your team can help.
- **Solve a disagreement:** Two people want to build different things. Work together to find a solution.

That turns the activity from simply **“Can you build a tower?”** into **“Can you work together as responsible members of a community?”**

Activity 4: Helping My Community Collage

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Citizenship/Social Interaction/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- magazines or printed pictures of community helpers and spaces (firefighters, food banks, parks, libraries)
- poster board
- glue
- scissors

What to do:

1. Talk with students about what a community is and the different people and places that help it run.
2. Let students look through magazines or pictures and cut out images that show people helping their community.
3. Glue the pictures onto a shared poster board to create a group collage.
4. Have each child share one picture they added and why it shows helping.
5. Display the finished collage at your next event.

Suggestion: Add a "How I Can Help" section where each child draws themselves helping in some way.

Activity 5: Texas & American Flag Craft

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Citizenship/Subject Matter Knowledge/Self-concept

Materials needed:

- construction paper (red, white, blue)
- glue
- star stickers or a hole punch
- craft sticks

What to do:

1. Show students a Texas flag and an American flag and talk about what the colors and stars represent.
2. Give students pre-cut strips and a star to assemble their own small flag.
3. Glue the flag onto a craft stick to make a small handheld flag.
4. Talk about times we see and honor our flags (Pledge of Allegiance, parades, holidays).
5. Practice saying the Pledge of Allegiance together as a group.

Suggestion: Use this activity near a patriotic holiday or your county fair parade.

Section: Geography

Activity 1: Make a Puzzle

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- a simple outline of the United States containing lines showing individual states
- Crayons, pencils, magic markers
- scissors
- cardboard for backing
- glue

What to do:

1. Give each child a map of the United States. Let them color each state, with an adult helper on hand for any student who wants help writing state names.
2. Glue the colored map to a piece of cardboard.
3. Trim to the size of the outline of the U.S.
4. Cut states apart to make a puzzle.
5. Divide the students into groups and time groups as they put the puzzle together. (Allow them to practice individually at first.)

Suggestion: **For younger children whose fine motor skills are still developing,** this game may be played using manufactured puzzles of the United States or of the world.

Activity 2: I'm Going to Take a Trip…

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- Seat players in a circle

What to do:

1. Leader should start the activity by saying: **"I'm going to take a trip to *(fill in the blank with a state or place)* and I'm going to take a *(fill in the blank with an item).*"** The next person repeats the first part and adds another item (animal, food, etc.) which begins with the same letter as the state named. Example: "I'm going to take a trip to Texas and I'm going to take a truck." or "I'm going to take a trip to the beach and I'm going to take a blue umbrella."
2. You can also play this game by changing the "I'm going to take a trip" to a specific activity, such as players could canoe down a river (i.e. I'm going to canoe down the Arkansas River and take an aardvark); or sail across a body of water (i.e. I'm going to sail across the Pacific Ocean and take a pineapple); or climb a mountain (i.e. I'm going to climb Mt. Everest and take an envelope).
3. When everyone in the circle has had a turn, choose another leader and go around again, naming another state or place.
4. Variation of this game: Players repeat what everyone is taking and add their own item last as they go around the circle.

Activity 3: What Am I?

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Social interaction

Materials needed:

- index cards
- scotch tape
- large signs with one of the following categories printed on them and taped in different areas of the room: continents, mountains, lakes, rivers, states, capitals, oceans

What to do:

1. Print the names of continents, mountains, lakes, rivers, states, capitals, countries, and oceans on index cards.
2. Shuffle the cards evenly so there will be an equal distribution of rivers, mountains, states, etc. Tape an index card to the back of each player, but do not tell player what they are, nor to which group they belong.
3. Tell players to circulate among the group, giving hints to one another, such as:
    - You are in a warm climate.
    - You are the longest "blank" in the U.S.
    - Your "blank" is Boise.
4. Players may not use the name of the category in their hints to one another.
5. After they guess who they are, they are to go sit in their designated area (have areas of the room designated mountains, states, rivers, etc.).

Activity 4: Around the World Day

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction/Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- a world map or globe
- simple facts, flags, and pictures from 3-4 countries
- an easy snack or recipe from one of the featured countries
- music from the featured countries

What to do:

1. Pick 3-4 countries to feature and find their flag, location on the map, and a few fun facts (favorite sport, a famous animal, a well-known food).
2. Show students each country on the map or globe and share the fun facts together.
3. Try a simple snack from one of the countries and talk about how food connects to culture.
4. Play some music from the featured countries while snacking.
5. Teach the group a simple greeting ("hello" or "thank you") in one or two of the languages.

Suggestion: If any students or families in your group have connections to other countries, invite them to share something special about their own culture and traditions.

Activity 5: Bake a State

(Note: You will need to secure permission to use the kitchen for this project).
Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- cookie recipe ingredients
- large bowls
- spoons, forks
- paintbrushes
- small juice cans
- wax paper
- assorted food colors
- rolling pins
- plastic knives

What to do:

1. Mix up an extra-large batch of cookie dough (any recipe developed for use with cookie cutters will work, just make sure there is enough dough for each child to fashion 1 or 2 cookies. Leftover cookie dough (and be sure to have some extra) should be baked into cookies for a snack so that students will not be tempted to eat their creation while decorating).
2. Recipe for cookies (makes 8 dozen)
    - Mix well in large bowl:
    - 1 ½ cups shortening
    - 2 cups sugar
    - 3 eggs
    - 1 ½ teaspoons vanilla
    - Sift together and add slowly:
    - 5 cups flower (not self-rising)
    - 2 teaspoons baking powder
    - 1 ½ teaspoons salt

3. Cover dough and chill for 1½ hours
4. In a small bowl mix 5 egg yolks and ¾ to 1 ½ teaspoons of water. If icing is too thick or dries while students are using it, add water. Divide the icing and pour into small juice cans. Pour a few drops of food coloring into each can to make desired colors.
5. When dough is thoroughly chilled, roll to about 1/8 to ¼ inch thick on a lightly floured sheet of wax paper.
6. Cut the dough into squares 5 x 5 inches. Allow students to choose a state and fashion dough into the outline of that state with a plastic knife. Using paintbrushes, paint designs of rivers, mountains, lakes, natural resources, etc., on the cookie. Place finished product on an ungreased cookie sheet and bake at 400 degrees for about 8 minutes. Allow cookies to cool.

Suggestions: This can be done as a group project by cutting out the outline of the U.S. and the individual states within so that they will all fit together when baked. Countries of the world may also be substituted for states. If possible, try to invite parents in for an after-work party to see the finished product before sending the cookies home.

Activity 6: Lewis and Clark Expeditions

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making skills

Materials needed:

- sketching paper and pencil

What to do:

1. Divide into small groups of 2 or 3 students.
2. Inform the groups that they are exploration parties and will be traveling through unmapped territory. They will need to sketch a map as they go along and will enlarge it later with details (fictitious names of towns traveled through, mountains crossed, etc.).
3. Each group will need a trail guide to lead the way and a mapmaker to sketch the route. Take turns so everyone gets a chance at each job. The names of places can be decided as a group, or an individual can be selected to do this.
4. The route chosen should lead past places of interest such as buildings, vacant lots, libraries, across streets, through parks, etc. Go slow enough to allow students time to sketch and use their imaginations. Discuss construction of buildings, kinds of trees, etc.
5. When the walk is over, draw maps on all sizes of paper, using various colors and patterns for geo graphical locations.
6. Give each group some time to tell about their travels, encouraging imaginative "tall tales."
7. Display maps on a bulletin board.

Suggestions: This activity can be varied in many ways.

- change the route
- choose a certain theme (a California Goldrush)
- each player makes their own individual map
- the group as a whole makes one map
- the route includes a grocery store where food is purchased for a simple snack (apples, cookies, etc.) or stop in a park for a picnic lunch.

Additional Geography Activities

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject matter knowledge

1. Invite someone from a foreign country to talk to the students about that country, exhibiting slides, pictures, and clothing articles.
2. If students have visited other states or countries, encourage them to talk about this and bring pictures of their vacation to the center to share with the other students.
3. Ask parents to volunteer some of their time to talk to the group about different places of interest which they have visited.

Suggestions: Older and retired people make excellent resources for activities such as these.

Section: Careers/Occupations

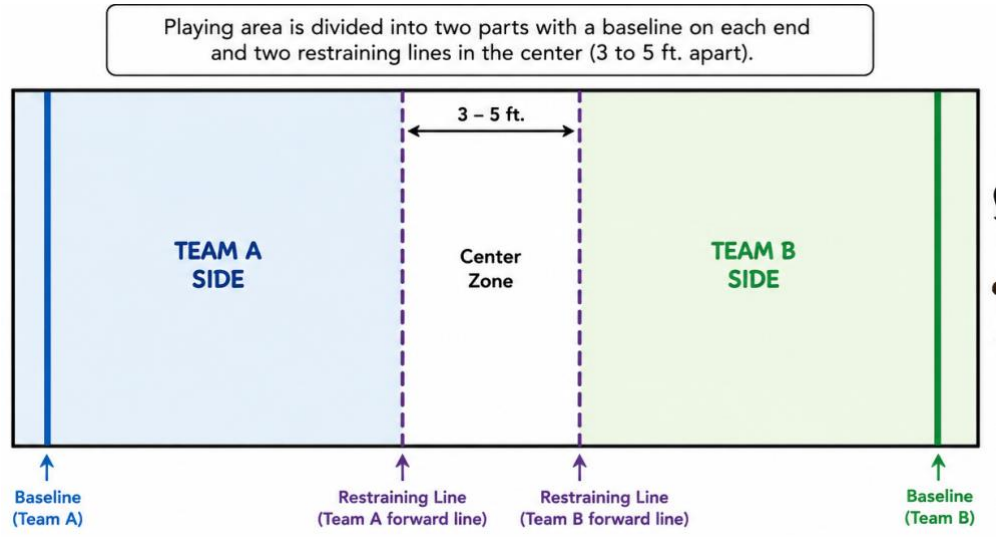
Activity 1: What's Your Trade?

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making skills/subject matter knowledge

Materials needed:

- divide students into two teams
- divide playing area in two parts with a baseline on each end and two restraining lines in the center (3 to 5 f t. apart)

What to do:
Set up the playing area by dividing the area into two parts with a baseline on each end and two restraining lines in the center. Each team has a back base line and a forward restraining line. The two restraining lines are at the center of the play area, 3 to 5 feet apart.



Divide the students into two teams. Each team gets together at their respective baseline and thinks of a trade or occupation which they may wish to pantomime (washing dishes, painting, mowing lawns, etc.).

The first team advances to the center of the area, and the two teams stand on their respective restraining lines. The following dialogue takes place:

- First team: **"Here we come!"**
- Second team: **"What's your trade?"**
- First team: **"We've got a skill that's homemade!"**
- Second team: **"Show us some, if you're not afraid!"**

The first team proceeds to go through the pantomime action showing their trade. The opposing team tries to guess what it is. As soon as they have called out the correct answer, the pantomime team dashes back to their base line, trying to avoid being caught by the pursuers. If they are tagged, they must go over to the opposite side, which has the next turn to pantomime.

Activity 2: Spinning Yarns

Audience: K–2
Life Skills: Self-concept, social interaction, decision-making skills

Materials Needed:

- A ball of yarn made from pieces of different colors and lengths of yarn
- Whiteboard or flip chart and marker

What to Do:

1. Talk about careers and as a group, ask students to name as many jobs and careers as they can think of. Write their ideas on the board or flip chart. Talk briefly about what people in those jobs do and how they help others.
2. Introduce the yarn and have students sit in a circle. Explain that the different pieces and colors of yarn represent all the different people, interests, and careers that make up our community. Just as the pieces of yarn are different, everyone's interests and career dreams can be different, too.
3. Share your dream – an adult can start by holding the end of the yarn and sharing a short example: “When I grow up, I would like to be a teacher. I would like to work at a school and help children learn.” The adult then passes the ball of yarn to the next student while keeping hold of their piece of yarn.
4. Keep it spinning and let each student take a turn sharing:
    a. What they would like to be when they grow up
    b. What kind of work they would like to do
    c. Where they might like to work

For students who aren't sure, offer simple choices or prompts:

    d. “Would you like to work with people, animals, or things?”
    e. “Would you like to work inside or outside?”
    f. “Would you like to help, build, teach, create, or explore?”

After sharing, the student passes the yarn to another person while keeping hold of their section.

5. When everyone has had a turn, have all students look at the web of yarn created in the middle of the circle. Explain: “Look how all of our yarn is connected! Our careers and the things we do can be different, but we are all connected. Communities need people with many different skills and interests.”
6. Reflect together and ask:
    a. “Did everyone choose the same career?”
    b. “Why is it good that people have different jobs?”
    c. “How can different jobs help our community?”
    d. “Did you hear about a job you had never thought about before?”

Activity #3: Dress for a Career

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making
Materials needed:

- old newspapers
- assorted paper bags
- scotch tape
- toilet tissue
- crepe paper

What to do:
Divide the students into groups of 4-5 or more. Give each group a card indicating what career or occupation they are going to be. Tell them they are to dress one person in the group as a career person:

- Doctor
- Nurse
- Baker
- Mail carrier
- Farmer
- Firefighter
- Construction Worker
- Chef
- Scientist
- Veterinarian
- Teacher
- Pilot

An adult volunteer should assist the group in determining what the job entails and how their attire can lead you to know what they do. Ask:

- What might they wear?
- What tools or objects might they use?
- Where might they work?

Set a time limit, then have each group present their model to the others. Let them guess what occupation they represent. Encourage the students to discuss what their specific career, what they do daily, and how someone can become prepared for that job. The group which guesses correctly may go next.

Additional Career/Occupations Activities:

- https://kids.usa.gov/Search online together for a few kid-friendly "day in the life" career videos to explore different jobs, or browse a career picture book from the library.
- Conduct a small “Career Day” by inviting several of the parents in to talk about their jobs exploring what they do, how the prepared for that job, and any other interesting details of their job. Encourage the students to ask questions.
- Make a Career Mural for the wall. Have students find magazine pictures of people doing different jobs or have them draw pictures of people working. Ask them to do some creative writing about what they would like to be when they grow up, places they would like to work, etc., and display the writings on the mural.
- Field trips could include banks, fast food restaurants, businesses, police station, fire station, hospital, etc.

Section: Performance Arts: Drama/Writing/Storytelling

Activity 1: Name the Animal

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/ Social Interaction/ Decision Making Skills

Materials Needed:

- 5" x 7" index cards
- pictures of animals cut from magazines
- designate one corner of the room as a "mystery corner." Equip with glue and index cards.

What to do:

1. Students come to the mystery corner one at a time, write their name on an index card, and select the picture of the animal he or she would like to be. Keep choices secret.
2. Glue picture to opposite side of index card.
3. Drop index cards into a "Mystery Box."
4. Arrange cards, animal-side-up, on a table ledge or pin to bulletin board.
5. Clear an area in the front of the room for students to come up one by one and act out their animal choice. (Example: Dogs bark and sit up and beg, etc.) Continue until someone guesses the name of the animal being imitated. Whoever guesses correctly has the next turn. As animals are guessed, turn index cards around so that the child's name is showing.

   Suggestion: Add extra animal index cards to the display so students will not be able to guess final cards by process of elimination.

Activity 2: Dress for Your Mood

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Social Interaction/ Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- a costume box containing assorted sizes of paper bags, fabric scraps, marking pens, yarn, tape, old clothes, hats, umbrellas, scarves, belts, socks, shoes, purses, etc.
- old magazines, scissors, glue, construction paper

What to do:

1. Make a costume that tells how you feel, shows your favorite color, or tells what you want to be when you grow up.
2. Cut out magazine pictures of items that will go with your costume and personality (i.e. house, car, pet, appliances, tools etc.). Glue on construction paper.
3. Allow time for each child to tell the group about their costume personality and chosen belongings.

Activity 3: Pantomimes

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction

What to do:

1. Explain that a pantomime is a series of certain thoughts, emotions, or actions which are acted out without words.
2. Discuss how feelings and actions can be communicated without the benefit of words.
3. Ask the following questions (use as many as time allows)

How would you act if you heard?

- a loud crack of thunder?
- someone whispering quietly?
- someone yelling?
- a baby crying?
- car tires squealing?
- a door bang suddenly?

How would you act if you saw?

- your best friend?
- Someone you don't know?
- a barking dog?
- a lost kitty?
- a building on fire?
- an alien being?

How would you look if you tasted?

- too-hot soup?
- hot chocolate on a cold day?
- lemons?
- a soda?
- salty soup?
- chocolate fudge?
- sour milk?

How would you look if you smelled?

- something burning?
- a skunk?
- your favorite dinner cooking on the stove?
- A rose?

How would you act if you felt?

- something sticky?
- tree bark?
- cotton?
- ice down your back on a cold day?
- a warm fire on a cold day?
- a swim on a hot day?

How would you look if?

- someone gave you a ferocious lion for a pet?
- someone gave you a beautiful ring?
- you lost the ring?
- you slipped and fell on ice?
- you got all A's on your report card?
- you saw someone being mean to your friend?

How would you walk:

- if you had to enter a room where a baby was sleeping?
- if mother caught you getting into the cooking jar before supper?
- if you were walking on ice?
- if you had broken your big toe?
- if you were wearing shoes that were too big?

How would you lift:

- a tiny baby?
- something hot?
- something heavy?
- something slippery?
- something sticky?
- something fragile?
- something big and bulky?

Activity 4: The Lost Story

Audience: K-2

Life Skills: Self-Concept/Decision Making Skills
Materials needed:

- lost and found sections from several newspapers and/or online news outlets
- scissors
- paper
- pencils

What to do:

1. Cut or print lost & found ads out of newspapers.
2. Read each ad aloud so students may select the ad they would like to use as a source for a short story idea.
3. Make up stories describing why, how, where, and when an animal or item got lost. Help younger students by giving them questions to answer while writing their stories, such as:
    - How did (subject) get lost?
    - Where did it go?
    - What happened to it?
    - Who found it?
    - Suggestion: Students may draw simple pictures depicting their story instead of writing it.

Activity 5: Playacting

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction

Materials Needed:

- A short three-act play. You can find these online OR most libraries, schools, and community theatre groups will loan their scripts for educational purposes. You can also use a story, song, ballad or poem in place of a play. The story should have conflict and suspense, not more than three scenes, plenty of physical acting, characters should seem real whether animal or human, and the story should appeal to the interests and tastes of the students who play it.

What to do:

1. Read the story aloud and ask: “Where will the scene take place?” & “How will the scene begin/end?”
2. When the story has been divided into scenes, choose characters.
3. Discuss what each character will do as they enter, etc.
4. Pantomime the play.
5. The second time around, encourage students to do their parts orally.
6. Discuss afterwards: “What made this scene so good?” & “Why was it exciting?”
7. Try to give each child positive feedback about their performance

Activity 6: String-a-Ring-Tell-a-Story- GameActivity 6: String-a-Ring-Tell-a-Story Game

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept /Social Interaction /Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- ball of string
- ring

What to do:

1. Have students get in a circle with enough space between them to touch one another's hands.
2. Pass the ball of string around the circle unwinding it so that each child sitting in the circle can hold onto it easily.
3. Place a ring on the string and tie the string ends together to make one long continuous circle.
4. Keep hands clasped to the string and move the ring from hand to hand and child to child.
5. Play music as the ring circulates.
6. Stop the music periodically. The child who has the ring must share a story with the rest of the group. (Ideas: most exciting vacation, how you got your first pet, a proud moment, etc.) Amount of time each child has to talk is flexible and will depend on number of students playing the game; however, each child should be encouraged to communicate and interact orally with the rest of the group.

Activity 7: Mother Goose Charades

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept /Social Interaction /Decision Making Skills /Subject Matter Knowledge

Materials needed:

- illustrated slips of paper with different Mother Goose rhymes printed on them
- a costume box with all sizes of paper sacks, fabric scraps, yarn, old jewelry, scotch tape, dresses, shawls, capes, etc.

What to do:

1. Divide into groups of two.
2. Give each pair an illustrated Mother Goose Rhyme.
3. Allow the groups 10 to 15 minutes to make an outfit, get props from the costume box, and talk together to figure out how to act out their particular rhyme.
4. Groups will act out their rhyme (without talking) before the other groups. Afterwards, the other students should try to guess the rhyme. The pair who guesses correctly may perform next.

Activity 8: Unravel the Story

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-Concept /Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- a ball of yarn made up of pieces of many kinds and colors of yarn segments. Vary the lengths of the colors.

What to do:

1. Sit in a circle.
2. Each one tells a story while winding yarn from the original ball. When coming to the end of a color or to a knot where one piece of yarn has been attached to another, the ball of yarn should be passed on to the next player who picks up the story, adding whatever he/she wants until the end of his/her color. This continues on and on around the circle until someone comes to the end of the yarn and finishes the story.

Suggestions: The ball of yarn should be made of pieces of many kinds and colors of yarn. Vary the length of the pieces. You might wish to make this activity appropriate to a theme, such as a camping trip, a hunting expedition, a family vacation, a Christmas story, a Halloween story, an Easter story, etc.

Section: Performance Arts: Puppets and Paper

Activity 1: Create a Seasonal Bulletin Board or Wall Mural

Audience: K-2

Life Skills: Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- large roll of white butcher paper or poster board
- old magazines
- finger paints, Crayola's, or magic markers
- glue

What to do:

1. Cut a large section of the paper/poster to length desired (estimate 18 inches per child). Tape paper/poster to wall or tabletop.
2. Let students color, draw, or paint background scenery for a scene: winter, fall, spring, or summer.
3. Have old magazines available for students to cut out pictures of people, animals, buildings, houses, etc.
4. Glue pictures on mural and hang for display.

Activity 2: Making Puppets

Audience: K-2

Life Skills: Self-Concept/Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

Bits of lace, ricrac, yarn, trim, odd buttons, left-over ribbon, felt, feathers, plastic or silk flowers, junk jewelry, old doll clothes, scissors, needles (with large eyes), embroidery floss, pins, tape, stapler, Styrofoam balls, old socks, lunch sacks, paper plates, old newspapers for patterns.

What to do:

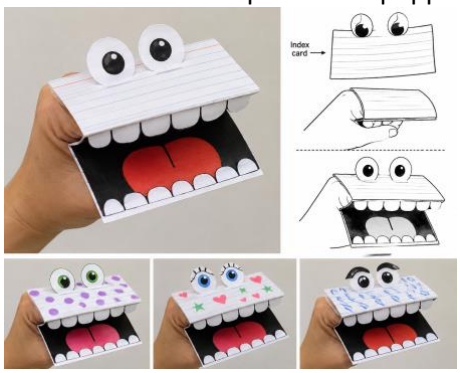
1. Have samples of the different kinds of puppets available.
2. Let students choose desired pattern.
3. Follow directions for specific pattern desired.

Puppet Choices: (See next page.)variations on pages ####.)

The Texas 4-H Youth Development Program expresses appreciation to JaneAnn Stout, Iowa State University Extension art and design specialist for use of 4-H publication Pm-1229, *Puppets for Kids*.

Variations of Puppets:

- **Walking puppet:** Draw a person or an animal on an index card or other stiff paper. Leave enough room at the bottom to cut two finger-sized holes. Fingers stuck through these holes will serve as the puppet's legs. Color the puppet and cut it out
- **Index card puppet:** This very easy to make puppet is simply an index card fitted into the curve of the hand (see sample image).. Glue cut-out eyes to the top of the card as shown in the drawing. Decorate the mouth part of the puppet with teeth and tongue.



- **Egg carton puppet:** Cut off the spikes inside a cardboard egg carton. (These spikes should resemble cardboard thimbles and will fit on the tips of the fingers.) Decorate these spikes to look like animal or people heads. With a puppet on one finger, the other fingers can serve as the puppet's arms or legs.
- **Paper sack puppet:** Put a face and body on a paper lunch sack. On the fold at the top of the sack, make eyes or a mouth that will open and close as the fold is manipulated. Use crayons or markers to decorate the sack. Or cut decorations from construction paper and glue to the sack.
- **Paper square puppet:** Cut two squares of paper. Squares should be about 3 inches across. Staple or glue the squares together on three sides. The fourth side remains open so three fingers can be put inside the puppet. Make a face on the puppet by gluing on colored construction paper.
- **Paper plate puppet:** Turn a paper plate into an animal, person, or monster puppet. Use crayons or markers. Or glue construction paper, cloth, or trim to the plate. Make a handle for the puppet by gluing or taping the plate to a tongue depressor or a strip of heavy cardboard. Try smaller plates, larger plates, and colored plates for a variety of puppets.
- **Milk or cream carton puppet:** Cut a fist-sized hole in the bottom or side of a milk or cream carton. Turn the carton into an animal, person, or monster by gluing on bits of colored construction paper. To move this puppet, slip hand through the hole and scoot the puppet along the stage.
- **Simple sock puppet:** A heeled, knee-high sock belonging to the puppeteer works well for this kind of puppet. Put the sock on the hand, with the heel fitting over the knuckles. Make a mouth by pushing the toe of the sock between the fingers and the thumb of the puppeteer. Take a few stitches on each side of the mouth to hold the mouth in place. Sew in button eyes, nose, ears, tongue, hair, or any other desired features.

- **Beak sock puppet:** Select a heeled or tube sock that fits comfortably on the puppeteer's hand. Turn the sock inside out , flatten the sock, and lay it flat. At stitch a "V" in the toe end of the sock, stitch a "V" shape (as shown in Figure A. Carefully cut along the outside of show. Cut close to the stitching. Remove and throw away the small triangular piece of fabric. Apply glue alongwedge. Finish the cut edge to keep it from fraying, by co n in figure A)ating it with glue or use a finishing stitch. Turn the sock right side out. Decorate your puppet! AddSew on eyes, hair, ears, feathers, or and other desired features using felt, yarn, buttons, or craft materials.. To operate the puppet, place your thumb and first finger inside the two sides of the toe opening. Curl youronly the thumb and first finger are extended. The other three fingers into your are curled in the palm. This gives the puppet a beak or long nose.Open and close your thumb and finger to make the puppet's beak or long nose move.



- **Sewn mouth puppet:** A heeled knee-high sock works well for this puppet. When the sock is on, the heel should fit over the knuckles of the hand. Trim toe of sock, following the curve of the sock. Trim so the sock is just slightly longer than the fingers when the puppeteer's hand is in the sock. (as shown in figure A). This leaves a mouth opening in the sock. Cut an oval the size of this mouth from a piece of washable felt. Turn sock inside out. With right sides of fabric together, stitch the oval to the puppet mouth. Then turn puppet right side out. Add face and other decorations to the puppet.
- **Ball and glove puppet:** Use a polystyrene ball as the head of this puppet. With pointed edge of scissors, carve out a finger-sized hole in the ball. Students will need help with this. Add eyes, mouth, hat, and any other desired features to the head. Another way to do this puppet is to make a papier-mache head, using the foam ball as the base. Dress up the puppet's body by wearing a glove over the hand.

  Flat fabric puppet: Draw a puppet outline on a sheet of paper. Make a simple shape, such as a gingerbread person shape. Keep the shape close to the size of the puppeteer's hand. Cut out the pattern through two thicknesses of fabric. Use medium to heavy fabrics such as terrycloth, heavy cotton, synthetic felt, and denim. Add decorations such as eyes, nose, mouth, hair, or clothing to each side of the puppet. Decorations can be sewn or glued to the puppet. Or use iron-on adhesive materials as decorations. With right sides out, glue or stitch the two puppet sides together around the outer edges, leaving an opening at the bottom for the hand. Glue fabric puppets with fabric glue. The edges usually don't need to be finished on the puppet. But if raveling is likely, trim edges with pinking shears or sew with a zigzag stitch.
- **Finger Puppets:** Obtain small gloves with fingers, old catalogs/magazines and glue. Cut small thumb-size faces of animals or people out of magazines and catalogs. Each child should have five faces, one for each glove finger. Glue faces onto fingertips of gloves. Allow students to

perform for their own entertainment and for one another. Instructors should suggest topics to help students get started but encourage individual and creative thinking.

Activity 3: Stage Projects

Audience: K-2

Life Skills: Social Interaction/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- a large cardboard box

What to do:

1. Cut off top and one side of cardboard box. Leave bottom on to make box more durable.
2. Decorate sides of box with construction paper, paints, crayons, or contact paper.



Activity 4: Happy Sad Faces

Audience: K-2

Life Skills: Self-concept/Social Interaction/ Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- newspapers and magazines
- scissors
- glue
- construction paper

What to do:

1. Look through old magazines and newspapers to find pictures of happy and sad people/animals.
2. Cut the happy faces out and glue on one side of the paper.
3. Cut the sad faces out and glue on the other side of the paper.
4. Give the faces names by cutting out large letters from newspaper headlines and gluing them on the page. The child may also like to find the letters in his name and glue it to the top of the paper.
5. Discuss why their people are sad or happy. Encourage students to share their thoughts with the rest of the group by asking questions like the following:
    - What do you think this father is frowning about?
    - Why is this little girl laughing?
    - Why is this dog growling?

Activity 5: Quick Draw

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Social Interaction

Materials needed:

- drawing paper
- pencils, magic markers, crayons

What to do:

1. Divide students into groups of four or five. Each group should have one chair in the middle of the group. Chairs should be at least 5 feet apart.
2. Number off within the group.
3. Call a number to come forward (example: "Number one, please come to the front of the room.")
4. Give each one a piece of drawing paper and a pencil, magic marker, or color.
5. Whisper the name of something to them (dog, flower, etc.) and tell them to hurry back to their chair and draw the thing you named for their group. The chair may be used for a desk to draw on. Artists must not talk to other group members.
6. The team which guesses the drawing first gets a point. Continue until all members have had a tum.
7. Display all drawings on a bulletin board.

Activity 6: Puppet Promotional

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Social Interaction/ Decision Making

Materials needed:

- magic markers, pencils
- glue
- old magazines
- scissors
- poster board of 2'x2' sheet or butcher paper

What to do:

1. Divide into small groups of two or three kids each.
2. Each group will make a poster to advertise the puppet plays they created earlier.
3. Clip magazine pictures, headline print, etc., and glue to poster board in any way child wishes.
4. When advertisements are completed, each group will try to "sell" the rest of the audience on their puppet show.
5. Plan a "WatchParty" so parents can watch their students perform with the puppets. If this is not possible, encourage students to per- form at home for other family members.

Activity 7: Paper Collage

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Social Interaction/ Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- various types of paper (newspaper, magazines, greeting cards, gift paper, paper sacks, paper towels, napkins, or tissue paper)
- a heavy piece of cardboard or thin plywood to use as backing
- glue, water
- picture hanger (soda can tabs can be used in the place of a saw-toothed picture hanger).

What to do:

1. Treat the cardboard or plywood backing with a mixture of one-part white glue and two parts water in order to avoid warping. Brush this mixture on front and back. Dry.
2. Select papers with colors and textures that the child likes. Lay them on the backing. Rearrange them until satisfied.
3. Glue each one down with the glue and water mixture.
4. When dry, paint over the entire design with the glue and water mixture. This will give a finished surface.
5. To hang, attach a saw-toothed picture hanger or pop can tab to the back.
   *An acrylic polymer mixture may be substituted for the water and glue. This may be purchased from any art store.



Activity 8: Paper Mache

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/Social Interaction/ Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- various kinds of paper
- water
- large kettle
- wire whisk
- strainer
- white glue
- dry wallpaper paste
- aluminum foil
- cardboard boxes and tubes
- paint

What to do:
Method 1 for younger students:

1. Tear paper into strips.
2. Coat with paste and layer onto a cardboard or paper form.
3. Dry overnight and paint with water base paint.

Method 2 for older students: (This method produces a smooth paper-like surface which can be sculpted like clay and sanded.)

1. To make one quart of mash, tear four large news- paper sheets into small pieces about the size of a quarter. Put them into a container that can be heated on the stove.
2. Add 2 quarts of water. Let the paper soak for 8 hours.
3. Boil the water and paper mixture for 20 minutes. Let cool.
4. Whip it with a wire whisk until soft and pulpy (like mashed potatoes) and place the pulp in a strainer to remove extra water.
5. Squeeze gently until the pulp is a soft lump, then put the mash back into a bowl and stir in 2 tablespoons of dry wallpaper paste and stir until smooth.
6. Store in airtight container until ready to use. It will keep for 2 to 3 days.

To use: Form the shape of an animal, mask, puppet head, etc., out of aluminum foil or by taping card-board boxes or tubes together. Shape the mash over the form and add features by using the thumb and finger. Use a pencil to shape small details. Most objects can then be sanded and painted with water base paint.

Section: Performance Arts: Music

Activity 1: Let's Make Music - Constructing musical instruments

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making
(This activity may take one to three days to complete.)

What to do:
Have samples of previously constructed musical instruments available for students to choose from. Help students construct instruments according to directions.

Melody Instruments

Water glasses: Eight water glasses or bottles can be filled with varying amounts of water to make a tonal scale They can be struck lightly with a metal spoon or if bottles, blown across to produce the tone. Mark the bottles or glasses with tape so that the next time they are to be used they can be quickly tuned. Large bottles or jugs can be tuned rhythmic instruments much like tubas, baritone horn, and string bass.

Tissue paper and comb: Place a clean piece of tissue paper over a clean comb. (The tissue paper should be the same size as the comb.) Place it in your mouth and hum a tune. This can be the melody instrument which other instruments accompany.

Humbuzzer: Use mailing tubes about 10 inches long. Punch 4 to 5 holes in a line: cover one end with wax paper held by rubber bands. Hum with open end over mouth. Holes are stops.

Tone Rhythm Instruments

Wind Chimes: For a surprisingly musical wind chime, all you need are 6 or 7 plastic pill bottles of different sizes and a plastic ring or spool from adhesive tape or ribbon dispenser. Use a heated nail to punch a hole in the center of the bottom of each bottle. Also punch 4 holes, evenly spaced, in the upper rim and 6 holes in lower rim of the plastic spool. With a large needle, thread bright yarn or string through the holes in the bottles. Knot yarn to keep it from slipping through. Suspend the bottles on varying lengths, but close enough so they can touch as they move in the breeze. Thread yarn through the 4 holes at the top of the spool and knot 4 pieces of yarn together about 5 or 6 inches above spool for hanging the chimes. A 7th bottle can be hung from the knot down through the center.

Banjo: On the cover of a small sturdycigar box cut a sound hole (half-moon or triangle 2 inches wide) and a slot. Cut a cardboard bridge, bottom part to fit tightly into slot. Tape down cover. For strings use 4 to 6 differently sized rubber bands. Stretch around box and over bridge. Pluck strings.

Flute: Use several bottles. To vary pitch, vary water levels. Blow gently in or across opening.

Clay flower pots: Inverted flower pots with a knotted clothes line put in the hole produce a melodic tone when struck gently by a stick or wooden spoon.

Rhythm Instruments

- Rhythm or percussion instruments with little or no discernible tone include drums, wood blocks, sticks, etc.)

Rhythm Beater: Thimbles beat time on jar lid.

Rattles: Put beans or rice in an old plastic bottle and seal the lid well.

Drum: Stretch heavy wet paper over top of large flower pot. Secure by rubber band. When dry, beat with clothes pin drum sticks.

Scratchers: Cover wood blocks with sandpaper. Scrapers: Scrape a thimble across a washboard.

Gut Bucket Fiddle: Washtub, mop or broom handle, any heavy cord. Fasten one end of mop handle to edge of inverted washtub, fasten heavy cord to other end. Fasten other end of cord in center of washtub. Angle of handle can be changed to change tone of string.

Castanets: Take a thin piece of wood about 8 inches long and 1 and V2 inches wide and hinge to a second piece about 5 inches long. Snapping the wood up and down makes a good clicking sound.

Handbones: Use feet, knees, and hands to keep time. (Song leaders can make valuable use of this rhythm technique to get people involved before and during musical sessions. Usually simple rhythm patterns are best with a group.)

Activity 2: Music Concert

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction

What to do:
Have students bring their favorite music (with parental permission) to center. Practice together in accompaniment to recorded music.

Additional Activities:

- Invite parents to a homemade musical jamboree. (Members may want to dress up in costume depending upon the song selection and/or event.)
- Record favorite songs with group accompaniments and share them with parents.
- Divide into small band groups and perform for one another.
- Perform for senior citizen clubs, etc.

Activity 3: Freeze Dance Rhythm Game

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Mastering Physical Skills/Self-concept

Materials needed:

- music player
- a variety of upbeat songs

What to do:

1. Explain that when the music plays, everyone dances, and when it stops, everyone freezes like a statue.
2. Play a song and encourage silly, big movements.
3. Pause the music at random and check that everyone freezes in place.
4. Continue for several rounds, letting a child take turns controlling the music.
5. Cool down with a slow song and gentle stretching at the end.

Suggestion: Call out a movement style before each round (tiptoe, hop, wiggle) to add variety.

BIG 5 PROJECT AREA: STEM & PHOTOGRAPHY

Science/Space.....72
Activity 1: Be the Sun, Earth, and Moon 73
Activity 2: Make a Constellation Viewer.....74
Activity 3: Sun Dial.....77
Activity 4: Human Sun Dial 77
Activity 5: Moon Phase Dance.....78
Back to Nature Art.....80
Activity 1: Pencil Shaving Art.....80
Activity 2: Cardboard Loom Weaving.....80
Activity 3: Pinch Pot.....82
Activity 4: Slab Pot.....83
Activity 5: Nature Sewing.....83
Activity 6: Wood Sculpture.....85
Activity 7: Foam Tray Printing.....85
Activity 8: Seed Mosaic.....87
Activity 9: Making Paper from Nature.....89
Activity 10: Sand Casting.....89
Activity 11: Popcorn Drawing.....90
Activity 12: Wire Sculpture.....90
Additional STEM Activities 94
Activity 1: Picture Hunt: My Favorite Things.....94
Activity 2: Shadow & Light Photography.....94
Activity 3: Sink or Float Science Lab.....94
Activity 4: Straw & Tape Bridge Challenge.....95

Science/Space

Activity 1: Be the Sun, Earth, and Moon

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Critical Thinking Skills
Materials: flashlight, dark room (if possible)
Goal: Youth will use their bodies and a flashlight to demonstrate how the Sun, Earth, and Moon move in space.

DO

1. Start with the Sun
Choose one child or adult to hold a flashlight. The flashlight represents the Sun.
Shine the flashlight toward an open space and say:
"The Sun gives us light. The Sun is very far away, but its light reaches Earth."
Have the "Sun" slowly move the flashlight from side to side.

2. Add the Earth
Choose another child to be the Earth. Have the child stand several steps away from the flashlight.
Shine the flashlight on the Earth.
Say:
"The Sun shines light on Earth. Earth spins like a top and travels around the Sun."
Have the Earth:

- Slowly spin in place.
- Walk in a circle around the Sun while spinning.

Ask: "Can you see the light on Earth?"

3. Add the Moon
Choose a third child to be the Moon. The Moon stands near the Earth.
Say:
"The Moon does not make its own light. We see the Moon because sunlight shines on it."
Have the Moon slowly walk around the Earth.
Point out that the flashlight's light can shine on different parts of the Moon as it moves.

4. Try the whole system!
Now have everyone move together:

- Sun: Hold the flashlight and keep it shining toward the Earth.
- Earth: Spin while traveling around the Sun.
- Moon: Travel around the Earth.

Have youth watch how the light and shadows change as the Earth and Moon move.

Safety: Never shine the flashlight directly into anyone's eyes.

REFLECT

- What did the flashlight represent?
- Which object gives us light?
- Did the Moon make its own light?
- What happened when the Earth turned?
- What happened to the light and shadows when the Moon moved?

APPLY

Have children switch roles and repeat the activity.

Ask: "Can you use your body and the flashlight to teach someone how the Sun, Earth, and Moon move?"

Challenge them to show what happens when the Moon moves between the Sun and Earth.

Activity 2: Make a Constellation Viewer

Note: Astronomy activities should be done throughout the year, so students can note seasonal changes and study these changes over a period. Collect daily and/or monthly information using the following project.

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Learning to Learn
Materials needed:

- Thumb tacks
- Paper towel or toilet paper rolls
- Aluminum foil
- Tape or rubber bands
- Constellation images (attached at the end of lesson)

DO

1. Cover one end of the cardboard tube with aluminum foil. Secure it with tape or a rubber band.
2. Use a toothpick to carefully poke holes in the foil. Copy a constellation pattern or create your own!
3. Look through the open end of the tube toward a flashlight or other safe light source.
4. Observe the stars of light shining through your holes.

****IMPORTANT: Never look directly at the Sun.**

REFLECT

- What pattern did you see?

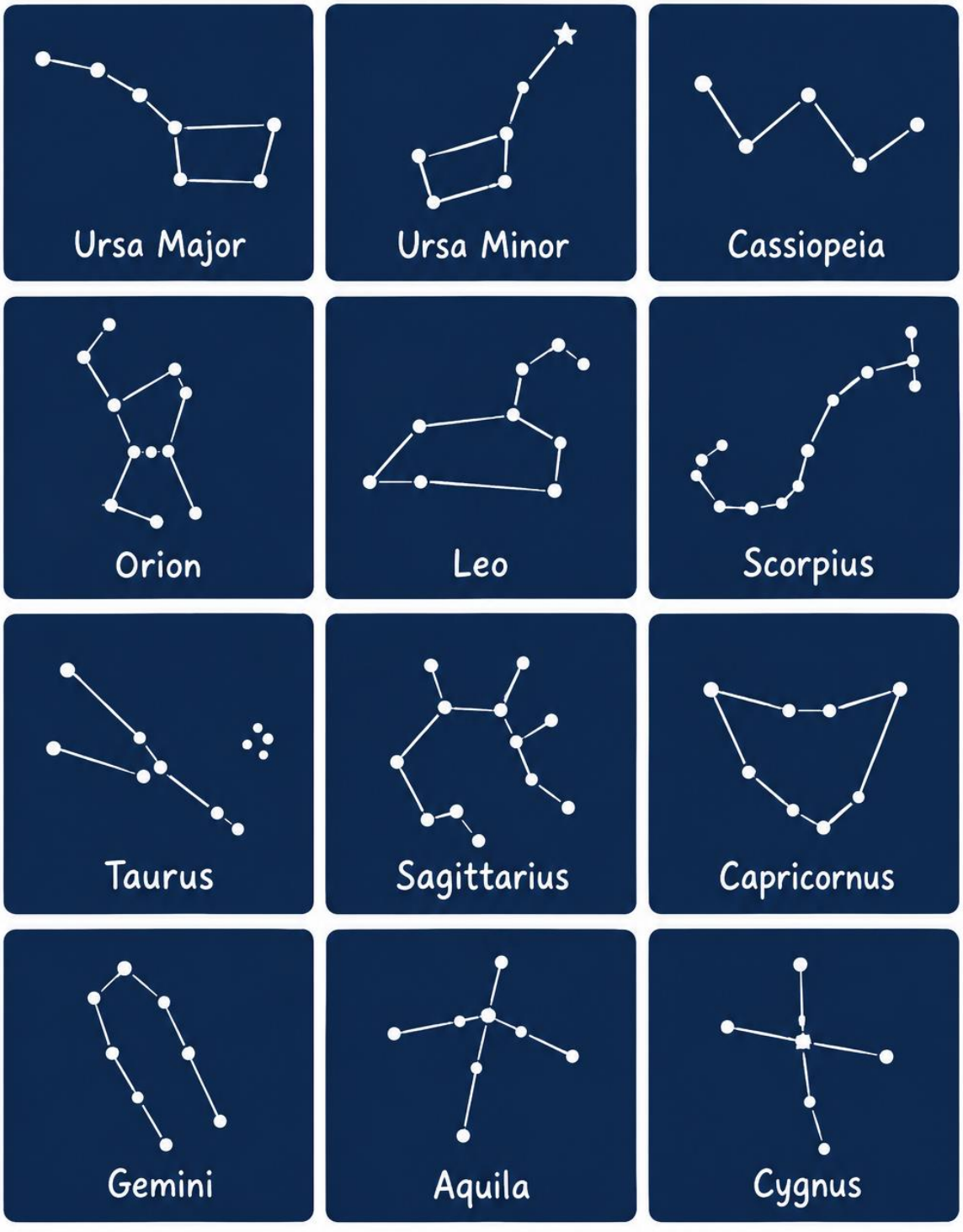
- How did changing the holes change your constellation?
- How does light help you see the stars?

APPLY

Create a new constellation! Make a different pattern of holes. Give your constellation a name and explain what you think it looks like.

Constellations

Use these patterns to punch holes in aluminum foil and create your own constellation!



Activity 3: Sun Dial

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Critical Thinking
Materials: Paper plate or piece of cardboard, pencil or straw, modeling clay, sidewalk chalk, and a sunny outdoor spot

DO

1. **Make the pointer.** Push a pencil or straw into a small ball of modeling clay.
2. **Place it in the center** of your paper plate or cardboard.
3. **Take it outside** and place your sundial on a flat, sunny surface. Make sure it will not be moved. You may need to weigh down the plate with rocks, etc.
4. **Mark the shadow.** Use chalk to mark where the pencil's shadow falls. Write the time next to it.
5. **Check it again later.** Every hour, mark the new shadow and write down the time.
6. **Watch the Sun!** See how the shadow moves and changes as the day goes by.

REFLECT

- What happened to the shadow as time passed?
- Was the shadow longer in the morning or afternoon?
- Did the shadow move in the same direction all day?

APPLY

Use your sundial to guess what time it is. Check your guess with a clock. How close were you?

Activity 4: Human Sun Dial

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Critical Thinking
Materials: Sidewalk chalk, a sunny outdoor space, and a partner.

DO

1. Find a sunny, flat area. Have one partner stand still while the other traces their **shadow** with sidewalk chalk.
2. Mark the time next to the shadow.
3. Return to the same spot later in the day. Have the partner stand in the same position and trace the new shadow.
4. Repeat at least **3 times** throughout the day.
5. Compare the shadows. Notice how their **length and direction** change as the Sun moves across the sky.

REFLECT

- How did the shadow change throughout the day?
- When was the shadow longest? Shortest?

- Which direction did the shadow move?
- Why do you think the shadow changed?

APPLY

Use the shadows you traced to predict where a shadow will fall at another time of day. Test your prediction and see how close you were!

Activity 5: Moon Phase Dance

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Critical Thinking
Materials: flashlight, small, white ball for each youth, dark room (if possible)
Goal: Youth will explore how the Moon appears to change shape as it moves around Earth.

DO

1. Make a Moon!
Give each child a white ball. Tell them: *"Your ball is the Moon. The flashlight is the Sun!"*

Have an adult or volunteer hold the flashlight in the center of the room.

2. Make a Full Moon
Have children stand with their backs toward the flashlight and hold the ball in front of them.

Look at the ball. The flashlight should light up the side facing the children.

Say: *"When we can see the whole bright side of the Moon, we call it a Full Moon."*

3. Move Around the Sun!
Have children slowly walk in a circle around the flashlight while holding their Moon in front of them.

Stop at different spots and look at the ball.

Ask: *"How much of your Moon can you see?"*

Help children notice that sometimes they see:

- A tiny sliver
- Half of the Moon
- Almost all of the Moon
- The whole Moon

4. Make the Moon Phases!
Call out different phases and have children move to the position where they can see that amount of light.

Keep it simple:

New Moon: "We can't see the bright side."
Crescent: "We see a little bit."
Quarter Moon: "We see about half."
Gibbous Moon: "We see almost all."
Full Moon: "We see the whole bright side."

REFLECT

- Did the Moon really change shape?
- What made the Moon look different?
- Where does the Moon get its light?
- Which phase showed the most light?
- Which phase showed the least light?

APPLY

Give each child a chance to be the Moon while another child holds the flashlight as the Sun.

Challenge them:

"Can you move your Moon to make a crescent, half Moon, and full Moon?"

Remind children that the Moon is always round—the amount of the Moon's sunlit side that we can see changes as the Moon moves around Earth.

Section: Back to Nature Art

Activity 1: Pencil Shaving Art

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/decision making skills

Materials needed:

- several days' worth of pencil shavings
- different colored yarn scraps
- construction paper (assorted colors)
- glue
- scissors
- pencils

What to do:

1. Outline a drawing of a furry animal or person.
2. Apply glue to outline of drawing.
3. Lay yarn on outline of drawing.
4. Fill inside of area with thin layer of glue.
5. Pour thin layer of pencil shavings on glued area.
6. Optional: Crushed eggshells or different shades of sand may be used instead of pencil shavings. Buttons or round felt circles may be glued on for eyes.

Activity 2: Cardboard Loom Weaving

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Marketable Skill

Goal: Youth will learn the basic over-and-under pattern of weaving while creating a small piece of woven art.

Materials Needed

- Piece of sturdy cardboard, about 8 × 10 inches per youth
- Yarn in several colors
- Scissors
- Glue or tape
- Large plastic yarn needle (optional)
- Ruler
- Pencil

DO

1. Make your loom.

An adult should prepare the cardboard loom.

- Draw a line about ½ inch from the top and bottom of the cardboard.
- Make small marks about ½ inch apart along each line.
- Cut small slits at each mark.
- The slits should be about ½ inch deep.

2. Add the warp.

The warp threads are the strings that run up and down the loom.

- Tie or tape one end of the yarn to the back of the cardboard.
- Wrap the yarn from the top slit to the bottom slit and back up again.
- Continue until all of the slits have yarn running between them.
- Tape the end of the yarn to the back of the cardboard.

3. Start weaving!

Choose a piece of colorful yarn.

- Leave a small tail at the beginning.
- Weave the yarn over, under, over, under the vertical strings.
- On the next row, go under, over, under, over.
- Gently push each row together with your fingers.

4. Change colors.

When you want to use a new color, simply stop the first yarn and start a new piece. Leave a small tail that can be tucked into the weaving later.

5. Finish your weaving.

When your weaving is finished, stop before reaching the top of the cardboard.

An adult can help:

- Remove the warp threads from the cardboard.
- Tie the warp threads together or leave them as a fringe.
- Trim any extra yarn.

REFLECT

- What did you notice about weaving?
- What happened when you went over the yarn? What happened when you went under?
- What colors did you choose?
- Was weaving easy or tricky?

APPLY

Challenge youth to make another small weaving using a different pattern.

Ask:

"What could you weave with yarn to make something useful or beautiful?"
Ideas might include a bookmark, decoration, bracelet, or small piece of art.

Activity 3: Pinch Pot



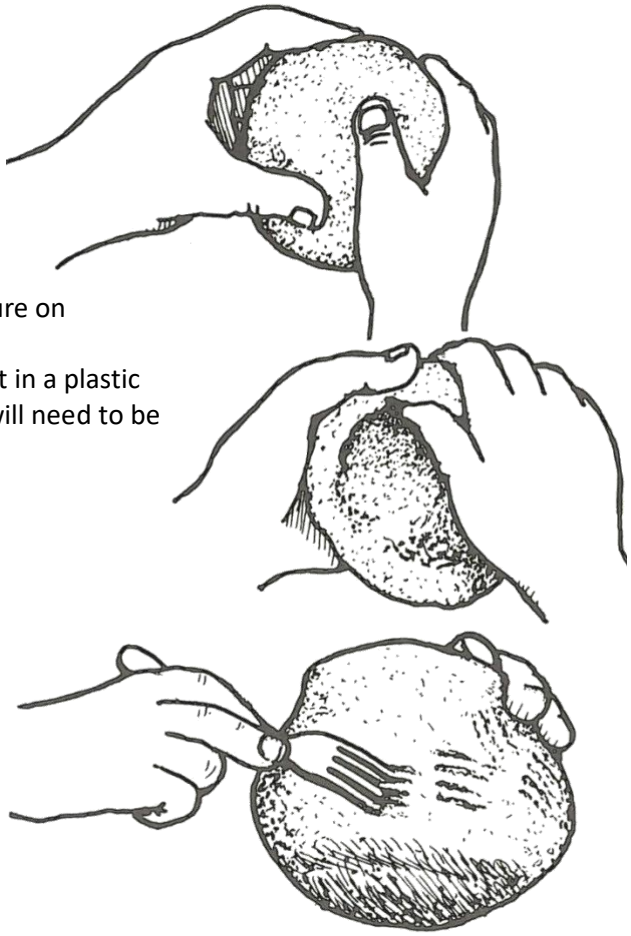
Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making skills
(Before doing this activity, try to arrange a field trip to a ceramic shop, or invite a skilled person to talk to the students. Try to arrange for the students' projects to be fired in a professional kiln. If this is not possible, use air-dried or oven-dried clay.)

Materials needed:

- commercial earthen clay in ready-mixed or moist form
- pencils, nails, other utensils to make designs with
- plastic wrap

What to do:

1. Form a ball of clay about the size of a baseball.
2. Push down into the center of the ball of clay with both thumbs.
3. Force thumbs out and begin to deepen and enlarge the hole.
4. Pinch and rotate the ball to build an even wall of clay.
5. With a pencil or other item make a design or texture on the outside of the pot.
6. To keep pinch pot from cracking as it dries, place it in a plastic wrapper and let it dry for 3 to 5 days. Large pots will need to be dried even more slowly.



Activity 4: Slab Pot

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making skills

Materials needed:

- a table covered with burlap
- rolling pins
- magazines, ½ inch thick
- bowls or balls or plastic covered rock
- commercial earthen clay in ready-mixed or moist form



What to do:

1. Roll clay out on table covered with burlap. A magazine on either side of the clay will keep the clay an even thickness as you roll.
2. Drape the clay over the plastic covered rock. Gently press the clay slab to the rock. Trim the outer edge to the desired shape.
3. Cover with plastic and let dry for two to three hours.
4. Remove the clay from the rock and decorate by pressing designs into the clay with tools and fingers while the clay is leather hard.
5. Fire

Activity 5: Nature Sewing

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Marketable Skill
Goal: Youth will practice the basic motions of sewing by threading natural materials through holes in leaves and other soft materials.
Materials Needed

- Large, sturdy leaves such as magnolia or large grass leaves
- Long blades of grass, vines, or thin flexible plant stems
- Pine needles or small twigs
- Yarn or thick string
- Child-safe scissors

- Small basket for collecting materials

Safety: Only collect plants from areas where you have permission. Avoid plants that may cause irritation or allergic reactions. Adults should check all collected materials before children collect them.

DO

1. Go on a nature hunt.

Take children outside and look for materials that could be used for sewing.

Look for:

- Large, sturdy leaves
- Long blades of grass
- Flexible vines
- Pine needles
- Small, smooth twigs

Have children collect a few items.

2. Make your "fabric."

Give each child a large leaf. An adult can use a hole punch to make several holes along the edge of the leaf.

3. Start sewing!

Show children how to thread a piece of grass, vine, or yarn through the holes.

Say:

"Push it through, pull it out, and push it through again!"

Have children practice going in and out of the holes, just like a sewing stitch.

4. Make a nature creation.

Children can "sew" around the edge of their leaf or attach two leaves together.

They can also add:

- Small pieces of grass
- Flower petals
- Pine needles
- Small leaves

Use yarn or flexible plant material to attach the pieces.

REFLECT

- What did you use to "sew"?
- What happened when you pushed the string through a hole?
- Was it easier to push the string in or pull it out?
- What did your nature creation look like?

APPLY

Ask:

"How do you think people long ago made things before they had sewing machines?"

Have children look around and imagine other things in nature that could be used as string, fabric, or a needle.

Challenge them to design something they could make using only materials they find in nature.

Activity 6: Wood Sculpture

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making skills
Materials needed:

- wood scraps of assorted sizes, textures, and shapes
- wood glue
- rags
- coarse, medium, and fine sandpaper

What to do:

1. Choose several wood pieces of different colors, shapes, and sizes.
2. Sand all pieces with coarse, medium, and fine sandpaper.
3. Wipe after sanding with a rag.
4. Glue pieces together to form a sculpture, using the largest piece for a base.
5. Glue one piece to another, allowing each to dry partially before adding another piece (so already glued pieces will not come unglued). Masking tape may be used to hold pieces together while drying.
6. When finished, leave it natural, stain, or paint the sculpture.

Activity 7: Foam Tray Printing

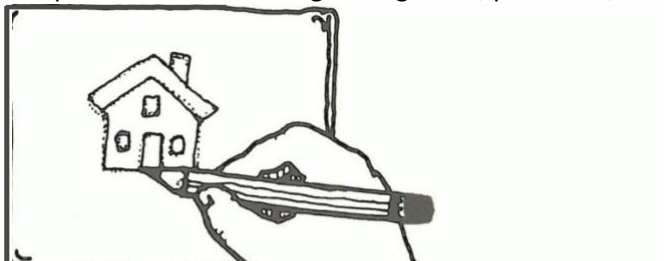
Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making skills

Materials needed:

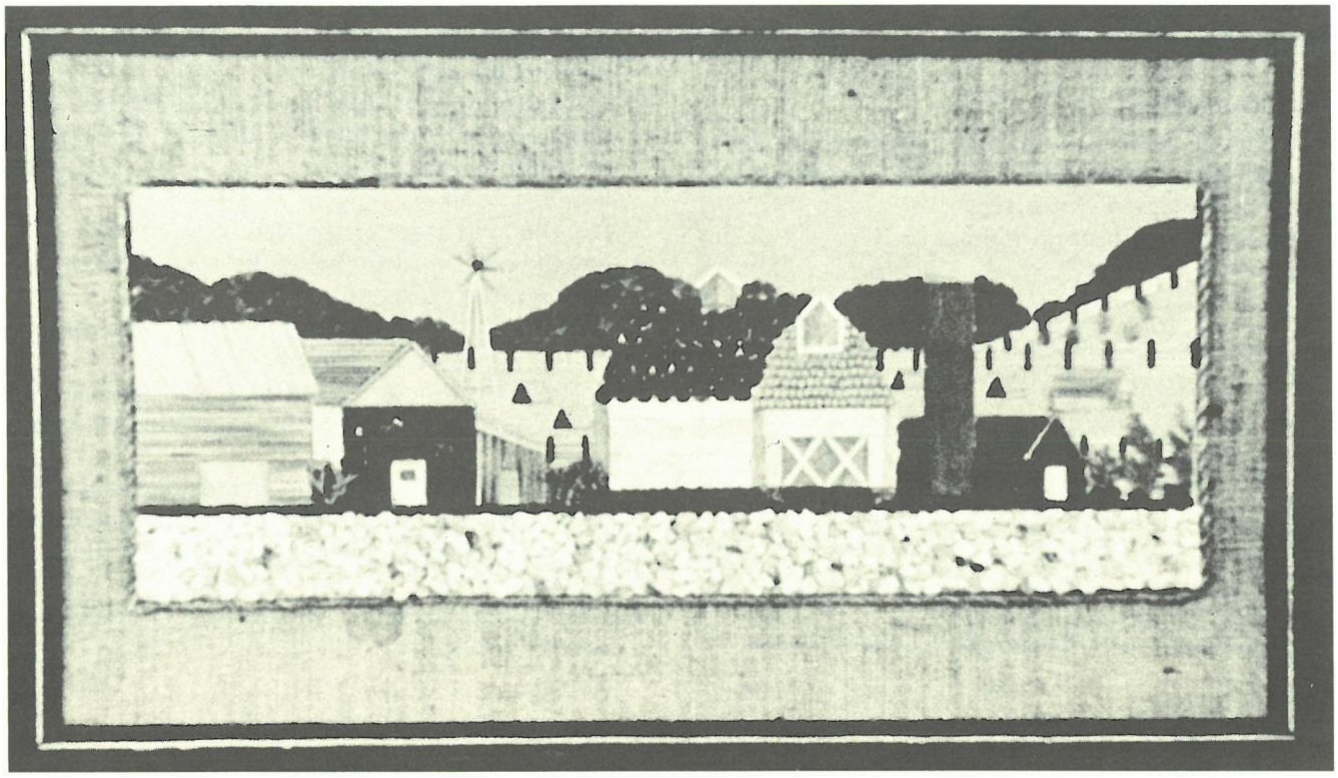
- foam trays used for packaging meat or bakery products in grocery stores
- scissors
- pencils
- brayer (available from art supply stores)
- acrylic paints or water-soluble ink
- paper for printing

What to do:

1. Using scissors, trim the raised edges off a foam tray.
2. Draw a design on the foam with a heavy pencil.
3. Put ink or paint onto a flat surface and roll the brayer (hard rubber roller) back and forth across the flat surface.
4. Ink the foam printing plate by rolling the inked brayer over it. Acrylic paints or water-soluble ink may be used. The ink should not flow into the drawn indentations but should remain on the flat surface.
5. Place paper over the foam and see the print that results from the drawing on the plate. Finished prints can be used as greeting cards, postcards, or stationery.



Activity 8: Seed Mosaic



Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept

Materials needed:

- thin plywood cut to size desired (A piece 8 inches x 10 inches is a good size; however, size may vary according to age group. A good rule of thumb to follow is this: The younger the child, the smaller the board.)
- a variety of seeds, all sizes, colors, and shapes
- white glue
- craft sticks
- picture hangers
- acrylic spray

What to do:

1. Draw a design on a piece of thin plywood. Create a variety of shapes within the large spaces.
2. Cover a small area within a shape with white glue. Use a craft stick or piece of cardboard to spread the glue. Arrange the seeds in the glued space. Proceed carefully and slowly.
3. When all shapes are filled with seeds, let the mosaic dry overnight.
4. After it is dry, spray the entire seed mosaic with acrylic spray.
5. Attach a simple picture hanger to the back by staples or glue.

Activity 9: Make Paper from Nature

Goal: Youth will discover how natural materials can be used to make paper.

Materials Needed

- Leaves, grass, flower petals, or other soft plant materials
- Small pieces of recycled paper or newspaper
- Water
- Bowl or bucket
- Blender
- Shallow tray or pan
- Screen, mesh, or old window screen
- Towel or cloth
- Sponge
- Rolling pin or another flat object

DO

1. Go on a Nature Hunt.

Take children outside to collect small pieces of leaves, grass, flower petals, and other soft plant materials.

Talk about how plants can be used to make different things.

2. Tear and Soak.

Have children tear recycled paper into small pieces and place them in a bowl of water.

Add the collected plant materials and let everything soak for several hours or overnight.

3. Make Paper Pulp.

An adult should put the soaked paper and plants into a blender with plenty of water.

Blend until it looks like a thick, mushy mixture called pulp.

4. Make a Sheet of Paper.

Pour some pulp into a shallow tray of water.

Have children gently place a piece of screen into the mixture and lift it up. The pulp should form a thin layer on the screen.

5. Press and Dry.

Place a towel or cloth over the pulp.

Have children gently press the pulp with a sponge to remove extra water.

An adult can carefully flip the wet paper onto a dry towel.

Leave the paper somewhere safe to dry completely.

REFLECT

- What did the leaves and grass feel like before we made the paper?
- What happened when we mixed them with water?
- What did the pulp look and feel like?
- What happened when the paper dried?
- What natural materials can you see in your paper?

APPLY

Ask:

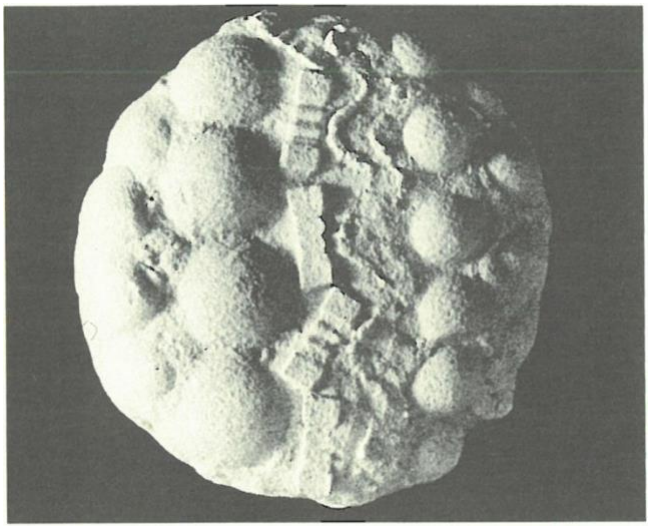
"What could you make with your nature paper?"
Children can use their finished paper to make a card, drawing, bookmark, or nature collage.
Extension: Try making another sheet using different leaves, flowers, or grasses. Compare how the different materials change the color and texture of the paper.

Activity 10: Sand Casting

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making

Materials needed:

- cardboard boxes (9-inches deep)
- plastic garbage bags
- sand
- spoons, sticks, spools
- Plaster of Paris
- Wire screening



What to do:

1. Line a 9-inch deep cardboard box with a plastic garbage bag. Fill with fine sand from a construction site, gravel pit, or lumber yard. Dampen the sand with water and pack it tightly into the box.
2. Scoop out some sand in various shapes and to different depths. This forms the design. Use spoons and sticks to move the sand. Spools and other items can be pressed into the sand to create shapes. Remove the spools, etc., after using them to create shapes.
3. Prepare molding plaster as follows: Pour the desired amount of water into the mixing container (a disposable container such as a milk carton is recommended). Add the plaster to the water gradually; stir as you add. Continue adding plaster until it is the consistency of pudding. Once the plaster is mixed, do not add more water.
4. Pour the plaster into the sand mold. Work quickly.
5. Before the plaster sets, add a metal ring to the plaster so you can handle the plaster cast.

6. Allow the plaster to harden before removing it from the box.

Activity 11: Popcorn Drawing

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/decision making skills

Materials needed:

- popped popcorn
- pencils, charcoal pencils, watercolors, magic markers
- white paper cut in different sizes and shapes
- construction paper
- rubber cement

What to do:

1. Pop a bag of popcorn. Be sure to pop some extra for the students to snack on.
2. On a sheet of white drawing paper, draw the kernels by tracing around them. Try to draw them larger than they actually are. Show the students how to shade the shapes in order to get lighter and darker effects.
3. Frame by gluing to a piece of construction paper slightly larger than the drawing paper. (Use rubber cement so that paper will not wrinkle.)

Activity 12: Wire Sculpture

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Self-concept/social interaction/ decision making
Materials needed:

- several yards of thin, soft wire (aluminum, copper, stove pipe wire). Younger students will need wire that is very pliable (such as soldering wire), or substitute pipe cleaners.
- a piece of wood to mount sculpture on
- wood staples
- nuts, bolts, washers
- monofilament thread or fish line

What to do:

1. Think of a bird, animal, person, or insect. Look up pictures of the item in books or magazines to see how it looks in lifelike movement or flight.
2. Practice bending the wire into different shapes and forms, then bend the wire into the desired shape. Older, responsible students may use pliers, if desired. Keep in mind that there is a big difference in the motor skill development of students. A younger child will not be able to copy a model as skillfully as an older child; however, encourage them to use their imagination. Do not expect them to copy any given model.
3. Wire sculptures can be one continuous wire or may consist of several lengths of wire joined together as the sculpture develops. If several pieces are joined, they may be hooked, wound, and twisted together.
4. Add other metal objects to sculpture in order to make it interesting.
5. To mount: sand, paint or stain a wood block base. Use a wood staple to fasten the sculpture to the block or suspend it with monofilament thread or fish line.

Additional Activities

- visit a craft organization in the community.
- visit a museum featuring creative art displays.
- visit the local art center or library.
- invite a professional artist to come to the center and share their crafts.
- display the students' creative arts projects and invite parents to an after-work tea.

Additional STEM Activities

Activity 1: Picture Hunt: My Favorite Things

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Self-concept

Materials needed:

- a camera, tablet, or phone camera (adult-supervised)
- a short list of picture prompts (something red, something round, something soft, my favorite toy)

What to do:

1. Give students, or small groups with an adult helper, a short list of simple picture prompts.
2. Let students search the room or yard for objects that match each prompt.
3. With adult help, take a photo of each object they find.
4. Gather together and look at the pictures on a screen, letting each child describe what they photographed and why.
5. Talk about how photography lets us capture and share things that are special to us.

Suggestion: Print a few favorite photos afterward and let students start a "My Favorite Things" photo book.

Activity 2: Shadow & Light Photography

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- a camera, tablet, or phone camera
- flashlight (for indoor version)
- sunny outdoor space (for outdoor version)

What to do:

1. Talk with students about how shadows are made when light is blocked by an object.
2. Take students outside on a sunny day, or use a flashlight indoors, and let them experiment making shadows with their hands and bodies.
3. With adult help, take photos of interesting shadows students create.
4. Look at the photos together and talk about the shapes they see.
5. Discuss how photographers use light and shadow to make interesting pictures.

Suggestion: Try this activity at two different times of day to see how shadows change in length and direction.

Activity 3: Sink or Float Science Lab

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Subject Matter Knowledge/Decision Making Skills

Materials needed:

- a clear tub or bin of water
- safe small objects (cork, rock, plastic toy, spoon, sponge, crayon)

- towels

What to do:
1. Gather a variety of small objects and lay them out for students to see.
2. Before testing, ask students to guess whether each object will sink or float.
3. Let students take turns gently placing each object in the water and observing what happens.
4. Sort the objects into two groups: "sink" and "float" based on results.
5. Talk about what the floating objects have in common, and what the sinking objects have in common.

Suggestion: Chart each child's guesses before testing to compare predictions with real results.

Activity 4: Straw & Tape Bridge Challenge

Audience: K-2
Life Skills: Decision Making Skills/Mastering Physical Skills

Materials needed:
- drinking straws
- masking tape
- a small toy car or block for testing
- two stacks of books

What to do:
1. Set up two stacks of books a few inches apart to represent a river to cross.
2. Give each small group of students straws and tape.
3. Challenge groups to build a bridge strong enough to hold the toy car or block.
4. Let each group test their bridge and talk about what worked and what they might change.
5. Discuss how engineers design and test bridges before they are built in real life.

Suggestion: If a bridge doesn't hold at first, encourage students to rebuild and try again rather than starting over with a new group.